Transforming Church and Mission

by

C. René Padilla

Foreword

by

Luis K. Bush

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Foreword

Transforming Church and Mission by C. René Padilla is one of the *Evangelizing Our World Inquiry* (World Inquiry) series of publications for the 2004 Forum for World Evangelization. It represents the perspective of a respected missiologist from the Majority World with regard to world evangelization in relation to the world, the Church and her mission.

With a strong biblical theological approach to these chapters, he writes on the mission of the Church in the world with clarity and persuasiveness. The book, as his title suggests, reveals a compelling unifying paradigm for mission of the church in the twenty-first century: "mission as transformation."

René Padilla was referred to as "one of the most important Third World voices in the contemporary international theological dialogue" by Gerald Anderson of the Overseas Ministries Study Center. He is one of the premier representatives of a Latin American perspective on the mission of the church.

> In 1974, he presented a plenary paper at the Lausanne Congress that argued that the gospel of the Kingdom has not only personal but cosmic dimensions which encourage a more active role among evangelicals in addressing social issues. Now, thirty years later, on occasion of another major global Lausanne Congress, he presents his position on the mission of the Church. The paper he presented thirty years ago along with the pre-conference questions of participants and answers by him, has been included in this volume in chapter three, titled: Evangelism and the World.*

It is still relevant today and makes for an interesting comparison to the other two chapters: "A Christian Response to Globalization, a lecture given at Wheaton College in 2003, and "An Ecclesiology for Integral Mission," which was written for the 2004 Issues Forum. There were also some notable differences from that time to this time. Thirty years ago, Padilla's missiological position appealing to the "whole gospel" was considered radical, today it expresses the position of the majority of the Church around the world.

But Padilla's interest goes beyond missiological reflection. In an e-mail he wrote me on April 22, 2004 as follows: "Honestamente espero que el Foro 2004

nos ayude a ser mejores hacedores de lo que decimos creer" ["Honestly, I hope that the 2004 Forum helps us to become better 'doers' of what we say we believe]."

Padilla was born in Quito, Ecuador, was reared in Bogota, Colombia, and since 1967 he lives in Buenos Aires, Argentina. The son of a tailor/evangelist and the sixth of eight children, he had a conversion experience when he was fifteen, and subsequently became an active evangelist by participating in a jail ministry, radio preaching on the radio station HCJB, and street preaching. He received a PhD in New Testament from the University of Manchester, Manchester, England, under F.F. Bruce and an honorary D. D. from Wheaton College. He has traveled extensively lecturing to university students, professionals, and pastors, and has been a visiting professor at various universities, theological seminaries, and missiological centers around the world. In 1976 he participated in the formation of the Kairos Community, to which he has been related up to now. He was selected to be the General Secretary of the Latin American Theological Fraternity (FTL) in 1984 which became a platform for his advocacy on missiology in various settings and conferences, the last of which was CLADE IV, held in the year 2000.

He is presently the President Emeritus of the Kairos Foundation, Editor-in-chief of Ediciones Kairos, Publications Secretary of the FTL and the International President of Tear Fund, United Kingdom. He is married to Catharine Feser since 1961, with whom he has four adult daughters, one son, and nineteen grandchildren.

"Mission as transformation" has become the compelling unifying paradigm for the mission of the church in the twenty-first century. It calls for a transforming church to go on a transforming mission to transform the world.

*The first chapter in *Mission Between The Times: Essays on the Kingdom*, by C. René Padilla (Grand Rapids: Eerdmans, 1985). This book has also been published in Spanish, Portuguese, German, Swedish, and Korean.

Luis K. Bush

Chapter 1

The Church, the Word and the Mission at the Beginning of the 21st Century

There is a solid basis for stating that the concept of *holistic* or *integral mission* has found its place in the evangelical community in many regions of the world.

Of course, there is a risk that the frequent use of the phrase could render it a mere cliché, an expression bearing no relation to the actual life of Christians or churches. However, there is abundant evidence to show that for a growing number of Christians and churches, the phrase *integral mission* encapsulates a distinctive way of perceiving their function in the world as disciples of Christ.

Intellectual assent to the concept of integral mission, however, is not enough to make it take concrete form in the real life situation of the local church. In order for this to take place, the church itself must fulfill *certain conditions or requisites that qualify it to practice integral mission.* This does not mean that there are formulae or strategies which will convert a church overnight into an agent of spiritual and social transformation in its community.

What it does mean is that churches that are making an impact that is truly *evangelical*---rooted in the gospel and consequently bringing about transformation in society---are churches that share certain characteristics that contribute to that impact.

What are these characteristics? What are the marks of a church which, through the power of the Spirit, is prepared to fulfill its role in its own surroundings as "salt of the earth" and "light of the world", a task to which all followers of Jesus Christ have been called?

Obviously, one prerequisite for practicing integral mission is to be *an integral church*. That is not to say a perfect church, for that would render integral mission impossible. It means a church in which God's Spirit is free to act so that in it the Word of God becomes flesh. It means a church which is making progress in its own transformation and the transformation of the community which it serves. More concretely, an integral church is a community of faith which gives priority to: 1) its commitment to Jesus Christ as Lord of everything and everyone; 2) Christian discipleship as a missionary lifestyle to which the entire church and every member

have been called; 3) the vision of the church as the community that confesses Jesus Christ as Lord and lives in the light of that confession in such a way that in it can be seen the inauguration of a new humanity; and 4) its use of gifts and ministries as instruments that the Spirit of God employs to prepare the church and all its members to fulfill their location as God's co-workers in the world.

1. COMMITMENT TO JESUS CHRIST AS LORD OF EVERYTHING AND EVERYONE

Integral mission is the concrete expression of the commitment to Jesus Christ as Lord of the totality of life and of all creation.

The Lordship of Jesus Christ

New Testament scholars generally agree that the confession "Jesus Christ is Lord" was the basic confession of the early Church, the avowal which demonstrated a person's relationship with both God and the community of faith. It is with respect to this confession that the following observations are offered.

In the first place, the most cursory reading of the New Testament will reveal the frequency with which the word *Kyrios* ("Lord") appears referring to Jesus Christ. In evangelical circles, the title "Savior" takes preference, reflecting the characteristic emphasis on the "salvation of the soul"[1]. In the New Testament, however, the title "Savior" is applied to Jesus on only a few occasions,[2] whereas "Lord" is used hundreds of times. Although it is certain that, in many of these references, especially in the Gospels,[3] *kyrios* does not carry the idea of deity a "high Christology" in the language of theological definition there are many examples which leave no room for doubt that the term is used to present Jesus as one deserving in himself the same honor as that which is offered to God.

In the second place, to understand fully the significance of the confession of Jesus as *Kyrios*, we need to interpret it with reference to certain facts about the historical context in which this confession took shape during the first century until it became a sort of synthesis of the faith and message of the primitive Church. One of these facts is that *Kyrios* is the Greek translation of YHWH (Yahweh), the name of God, in the Septuagint. Therefore, to speak of the Lord is to speak of God, no more and no less. It is not surprising then that, in the New Testament, there are quotations from the Old Testament which use the word *kyrios*, which originally referred to God, but which in the New Testament refer to Jesus. Another fact is that in the emperor worship of the first century, the emperor was referred to as *Kyrios* to emphasize the absolute nature of his authority, characteristic of a god. Furthermore, in the same period in Asia Minor, Syria and Egypt there were religions in which the gods and goddesses (for example Isis and Osiris) also acquired the title *Kyrios* and *Kyria*. The confession of Jesus as *Kyrios,* therefore, stands over against other confessions and allegiances

present in the religious world, and led Paul to affirm:

> we know that 'no idol in the world really exists', and that 'there is no God but one'. Indeed, even though there might be many so-called gods in heaven or on earth as in fact there are many gods and many lords yet for us there is one God, the Father, from whom are all things and for whom we exist, and one Lord, Jesus Christ, through whom are all things and through whom we exist (1Co 8:4-6).[tr]

When these facts are taken into consideration, it becomes clear that *the confession of Jesus Christ the risen Christ as Lord is essentially a recognition of his sovereignty over the whole of human life and over the whole creation.* According to the apostle Paul, such a recognition is possible only through the action of the Spirit of God (1Co 12:3). Christians are, by definition, "those who call upon the name of our Lord Jesus Christ" (1Co 1:2; cf. Ac 9:14, 21; 22:16; 2Ti 2:22); those who have received "the word of faith," which the apostle to the gentiles summarizes:

> "If you confess with your lips that Jesus is Lord and believe in your heart that God raised Him from the dead, you will be saved. For one believes with the heart and so is justified, and one confesses with the mouth and so is saved" (Ro 10:9-10).

In the third place, the confession of Jesus Christ as Lord, which could well be considered the core of the apostolic message[4], amounts to saying that *the Kingdom of God has become a present reality in history, in the person and work of Jesus Christ*, an affirmation which is corroborated by the gospels, without at the same time putting in doubt the future dimension of the Kingdom.

Among New Testament scholars there is a consensus that the Kingdom of God was Jesus' principal message, and there are few who would not recognize that for him that Kingdom was as much present as future. This double dimension of the Kingdom derives from the fact that *basilea* ("reign" or "kingdom" in Greek) in the New Testament, as in many cases with *malkut* ("reign" in Hebrew) in the Old Testament, means something dynamic: "sovereignty", "dominion", or "government". It does not, therefore, refer to a territorial realm in the present, nor to an eschatological realm which will come into being in the future. It is about the power of God in action, the royal power of God which, anticipating the end, manifests itself in the present through Jesus Christ, and will manifest itself in the future in all its fullness.

A question remains, however: If in the preaching of Jesus the Kingdom of God holds such a prominent position, why does it scarcely appear in the preaching of Paul and the other apostles?"[5] The best answer appears to be that in the Greco-Roman world it made much more sense to proclaim the universal sovereignty of

Jesus Christ in terms of his *lordship* rather than his kingly power as David's heir. The use of *Kyrios* in the proclamation of the gospel by the apostle to the gentiles is a clear New Testament illustration of the contextualization of the message in the first century. The use of the same title in preaching in a Jewish context, however, shows that, as Cullmann says, "it is clear that whenever Paul mentions the confession of Christ as Lord, he draws upon an old tradition and presupposes acquaintance with it as the foundation of all proclamation of Christ."[6] It is evident that, from the very beginning of the Church, Christians understood the exaltation of Jesus Christ, after his resurrection, to be his enthronement as Lord and King of the universe. Thus Acts 2:36 when Peter in his Pentecost sermon says about Jesus that "God has made him Lord and Messiah" provides evidence, along with other passages, that this conviction was already part of the message of the Church in Palestine.

The relation between the resurrection and exaltation of Christ and his enthronement as *Kyrios* is shown clearly in a passage in which Paul writes that the power of God in the lives of believers is the same as that which God 'put to work in Christ when he raised him from the dead and seated him at his right hand in the heavenly places, far above all rule and authority and power and dominion, and above every name that is named, not only in this age, but in the age to come. And he has put all things under his feet and has made him head over all things for the Church' (Eph 1: 20-22).

This is another way of claiming that the risen Christ has been made "Lord of everything and everyone"; that he has been enthroned to exercise, by the power of God, sovereignty over all creation ("all things"): "Jesus Christ is Lord". Following the same line, the Christological hymn in Philippians 2:6-11 traces the trajectory of Jesus Christ from his position of equality with God, through his descent to the condition of slave, to his humiliation in death, the death of a cross, to his exaltation to the highest place as Lord, at whose name every knee shall bow and every tongue confess that he is *Kyrios Jesus Christos.* It is as such, says Paul to the Ephesians (1:22), that God has given him to the church for it to confess him and proclaim him to all nations.

From Christology to Ecclesiology

The lordship of Jesus Christ is the foundation of both the life and the mission of the Church. In the so-called "Great Commission" according to Matthew 28:16-20, the charge to "make disciples"[7] is preceded by the affirmation of the universal sovereignty of the risen Christ: "All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me," he says. "Go *therefore* and make disciples of all nations" (vv. 18-19a, italics mine).

Because Jesus Christ is the Lord of the whole universe, he must be proclaimed as such among all nations, and in all nations

disciples must be made who will confess his name and live in the light of that confession. The compass of this confession of his lordship must match the degree of authority conferred on him by the Father. The christology summarized in the confession "Jesus Christ is Lord" constitutes the basis of an ecclesiology that sees the Church as the community that confesses and proclaims Jesus as Lord of the whole of human life and of the whole of creation.

Without the affirmation of Jesus as Lord, there is no integral Gospel, and without an integral gospel there can be no integral mission. It is here that the problem arises with those versions of the Christian message which restrict the action of Jesus Christ to the realm of private religion "the spiritual" and leave out all references to his authority over other aspects of human life. If Jesus Christ is Lord of the whole universe and has been granted sovereignty in heaven and on earth, his dominion extends over both the economic and the political spheres, over the social and the cultural, over the aesthetic and the ecological, over the personal and the communal. Nothing and no one is excluded from his authority.

When the Church loses sight of the centrality of the Lord Jesus Christ, it ceases to be the Church and is reduced to being a religious sect, incapable of relating its message to daily life and public life. *The integral church is one which recognizes that all spheres of life are "mission fields" and looks for ways of asserting the sovereignty of Jesus Christ in all of them.* The lordship of Christ is the foundation of an integral ecclesiology and of integral mission. Questions about *what the Church is and why the Church exists* can only be answered after we have answered the prior question of *who is Jesus Christ.* If Jesus Christ is Lord of everything and every one, the Church is the *Church of Christ* in the measure that it sees itself as "the community of the King" Jesus the Christ and defines the purpose of its existence in terms of witnessing to him, not only by what it says, but also by what it is[8] and by what it does. If Jesus Christ is Lord of everything and everyone, the Church is not an agent of "individual salvation" which brings into people's grasp the benefits of Christ's work, but rather the community of faith called to incarnate the testimony to his lordship over the whole of life.

2. CHRISTIAN DISCIPLESHIP

Christian discipleship, understood as a missionary lifestyle--the active participation in the realization of God's plan for human existence and the creation revealed in Jesus Christ to which the whole Church and each of its members is called, expresses, in a word, the essence of the Church's mission.

If, as we have stated above, the Church is the community that confesses Jesus Christ as Lord and lives in the light of that confession, it follows that the proclamation of Jesus Christ as Lord and the all inclusive invitation to submit oneself to his

authority are inescapable elements of the Church's mission. As Paul argues:

> There is no distinction between Jew and Greek; the same Lord is Lord of all and is generous to all who call on him. For, 'Everyone who calls on the name of the Lord shall be saved.' But how are they to call on one in whom they have not believed? And how are they to believe in one of whom they have never heard? And how are they to hear without someone to proclaim him? And how are they to proclaim him unless they are sent? (Ro 10: 12-15a).

Any one who hears the gospel and responds positively sets out to *follow Jesus, a process of transformation lasting a whole lifetime and extending to every aspect of life*. Several comments are in order here.

First, in evangelical circles there has been a marked tendency to emphasize conversion as an action taken at a particular moment in which a person passes from death to life, through a personal decision and (it is assumed) the action of the Holy Spirit. It is not uncommon, therefore, for the believer to give the date of his or her conversion.

Obviously, without repentance and without faith there is no discipleship. However, beyond the experience of the moment with which Christian living begins, and which one can not always date, it must be affirmed that God's aim is to recreate in the believer the image of his Son Jesus Christ, the New Man, and that this involves a process of transformation which lasts throughout the whole of life. Jesus' words in Matthew's "Great Commission" about *how* to "make disciples" call attention to this process: 1) "baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit", the rite of initiation into following Jesus and, therefore, into the Christian life; and 2) "teaching them to obey everything that I have commanded you", the process of formation *in* the practice and *for* the practice of Jesus' teaching the will of God without which there can be no genuine discipleship.

From a Biblical perspective, *orthopraxis,* obedience to all that Jesus taught his disciples, is at least as important as orthodoxy, if not more so, since the disciples' goal is to live out the practice of love and thus to be "children of your Father in heaven", "perfect as your heavenly Father is perfect" (Mt 5:45, 48). Jesus' disciples are not distinguished by mere adherence to a religion, a Jesus cult, but rather by a lifestyle which reflects the love and the justice of the Kingdom of God. The Church's mission, therefore, cannot be reduced to proclaiming the "salvation of souls". Her mission is to "make disciples" who will learn obedience to their Lord in all the circumstances of daily existence, private and public, personal and social, spiritual and material. *The call of the gospel is a call to a total transformation that reflects God's purpose to redeem human life in all its dimensions.* Integral mission becomes possible only

when there are disciples who have the vision to ensure that the leaven of Kingdom values permeate every sphere of society.

Secondly, Jesus assumes that there is a whole body of teaching which he has entrusted to the keeping of his disciples and which they, in turn, need to communicate to new disciples. The assumption is that there is a tradition which is passed on from one generation to the next, a tradition essential for putting into practice the commission to make disciples of the Lord Jesus Christ. This is actually a reference to the *apostolic tradition* (or *teaching*) to which several later New Testament passages will refer (see, e.g., Ac 2:42; Ro 6:17; 1Co 11:23; Gal 1:8-9; Col 2:6-8).

It must be kept in mind, however, that Jesus' teaching was not merely, or even primarily, doctrinal or theoretical, but rather practical and exemplary. That is to say, his teaching consisted, above all, of his example and his actions, through which he communicated the values of the Kingdom of God incarnated in himself. So, for example, in order to teach the importance of humble service in the community of his followers, on his last journey to Jerusalem he referred to himself as "the Son of Man [who] came not to be served but to serve and to give his life as a ransom for many" (Mk 10: 43-45). Then in the upper room, shortly before his crucifixion, he washed his disciples' feet and then said to them, "I have set you an example, that you should also do as I have done to you" (Jn 13:15). There can be no doubt that this sort of teaching is an essential part of the apostolic tradition, the "commandment" which he entrusted to his followers so that they could fulfil their mission to make disciples.

Consequently, the disciples' mission would not be limited to making converts in order to increase the numbers of church members. It would be directed, rather, to making disciples whose lifestyle would reproduce the example of Jesus Christ: an example of unconditional love for God and neighbour, of humble service and solidarity with the poor, of commitment to the truth and unshakeable opposition to all forms of hypocrisy. In other words, the mission of the Church would consist of an invitation and a challenge to set out as followers of Jesus as a means to "recover" Jesus, "the most radical way of recovering the concrete reality of Jesus and making of it the origin and basis of the whole of life"[9].

Understood in these terms, discipleship is costly, and it is a cost that cannot be evaded. One aspect of it is the renunciation of everything that interferes with absolute fidelity to Jesus Christ as Lord. In a time of popularity when "great multitudes" were following him, Jesus turned to them and said, "Whoever comes to me and does not hate father and mother, wife and children, brothers and sisters, yes, and even life itself, cannot be my disciple. Whoever does not carry the cross and follow me cannot be my disciple." He spoke about counting the cost, as when one plans to build a tower,

or when a king is about to go to war with another king. Then he added, "So therefore none of you can become my disciple if you do not give up all your possessions" (Lk 14:25-33). Jesus is the one who defines the conditions of discipleship. He defines them in a way that leaves no doubt that his call is to an integral discipleship, one that requires radical obedience to the will of God in all areas of life, from family relationships to material possessions.

Thirdly, the formation of disciples after the pattern of Christ takes place in the context of the community of faith, not separate from it. Jesus said: "By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you have love for one another" (Jn 13:35). Clearly, for Jesus the mark of discipleship is love.

However, nobody can learn to love in isolation from others. In effect, the knowledge "the experience" of the love of Christ, which, in Paul's words "surpasses knowledge", is possible only "with all the saints" (Eph 3:18-19). It is in the Church, "the family of God", that disciples learn to love, and not only to love, but to serve, to pray, to renounce evil, and to nurture what is good. It is in the Church, "the body of Christ", that disciples discover and use their gifts and grow into "the unity of faith and of the knowledge of the Son of God, to maturity, to the measure of the full stature of Christ" (Eph 4:13). It is true that starting out on the road to discipleship clearly requires a personal decision, a decision involving an irrevocable renunciation of a life independent of God and a readiness to identify oneself with Jesus in his sufferings. It is also true, however, that those who embark on the way as followers of Jesus can only make progress in the pilgrimage to the extent that they are able to experience the grace of God *in* the Church and *through* the Church.

The practice of integral mission assumes that the Church and each of its members will give absolute priority to following Jesus in terms of a missionary lifestyle: a way of life modeled on Jesus for the purpose of bearing witness, by word and action, to Jesus Christ the Lord; a way of life-centered on Jesus Christ as the Event through whom God has definitively wrought the re-establishment of his purpose for the whole of his creation.

Such a lifestyle is truly "evangelical", not in a sectarian sense, in which to be evangelical means to be identified with a ghetto-church that thinks it has a monopoly on truth, but in the broad meaning of the word: to be evangelical means to be entirely dependent on the grace of God shown in Jesus Christ, to be committed to him as Lord of the whole of life and the whole of creation, and to join in the spreading of the good news of Jesus as "the way, the truth and the life" (Jn 14: 6).

As John H. Yoder says,

> The message cannot remain in the ghetto because the good news by its very nature is for and about the world. The good news is not information

> which will remain true even if people in a ghetto celebrate it only for themselves; it is about a community-building story for which the world beyond the ghetto is half of the reconciling event.[10]

3. A BIBLICAL VISION OF THE CHURCH

The Church is the community that confesses Jesus Christ as Lord of everything and everyone and lives in the light of this confession in such a way that in it may be seen the inauguration of a new humanity.

The Church is not just the sum total of the individuals who come together on the basis of shared religious interests. From the point of view of the New Testament, the Church holds a central place in salvation history because it is the testimony to God's great purpose in Jesus Christ. Its witness, however, is not limited to words only. Its witness is essentially *incarnational*. What does this mean?

Obviously, the adjective refers to the central act of God in history, the incarnation. At the outset, it is fitting to warn that the idea of the Church as "extension of the incarnation", common in Roman Catholic dogmatics, does not do justice to the enormous difference which, from a biblical standpoint, exists between Jesus Christ and the Church. That, however, is not to deny that there is a close relationship between the life and mission of the Church, on the one hand, and the life and mission of Jesus Christ, on the other. Without effacing the distinctive character of Jesus' work in the "salvific events", we can still affirm, without fear of contradiction, that this work is extended and made effective in history, through the power of the Spirit, by means of the life and mission of the Church.

As was stated above, the basis of the mission of the Church is the lordship of Jesus Christ. Because he has received all authority in heaven and on the earth, the Church is called to make disciples in all nations. Jesus Christ in this way provides the *why* of the mission. At the same time, he provides us with the content, the *what,* of the message. Thus Paul says, Awe do not proclaim ourselves; we proclaim Jesus Christ as Lord" (2Co 4:5). What is the gospel if it is not precisely *good news about Jesus Christ?* The mission of the Church is incarnational when it is centered on the Word of God who was made man.

The incarnation of God in Jesus Christ, however, provides not only the *why* and the *what* of the mission; it also provides the *how.* The risen Christ said to his disciples, "As the Father has sent me, so I send you" (Jn 20:21). The implications are clear. The form of Jesus' commissioning by the Father provides the model or paradigm for the commissioning of his followers the commissioning whereby disciples are made.

To understand in what sense Jesus' mission serves as a paradigm for the mission of the Church, it is necessary to take into account the totality of the "saving events" by which Jesus fulfilled his

mission: his life and ministry, his death on the cross, his resurrection and his exaltation. Each of these events points towards integral mission as the means whereby the Church continues Jesus' mission throughout history, and whereby the redemptive work of Jesus takes effect under present circumstances.

The Church and the life and ministry of Jesus

The traditional tendency to separate the death of Jesus from his earthly life and ministry "a marked tendency in evangelical circles" in order to give prominence to the cross, has resulted in a sad lack of attention to the significance of his life and ministry for the mission of the Church. True, the four Evangelists emphasize the passion and death of Jesus Christ to the point where there is a lot of truth in what has been said about the Gospels, namely that they are essentially narratives about the happenings immediately prior to the crucifixion, with more or less extensive introductions. And then Paul, too, emphasizes the centrality of the cross when he says that he preaches "Christ crucified" (1Co 1:23; cf. 2:2). However, what gives validity to the death of Jesus Christ as "the atoning sacrifice for our sins" (1Jn 4:10) is that it was the sacrifice of the perfect man, whose way of life established the foundations for the definition of what it means to love God above all things and to love one's neighbour as oneself. His earthly life and ministry in this way came to be the model for the life and mission of the Church.

One of the more praiseworthy elements of the Latin American theology of liberation was its emphasis on the historical Jesus as a paradigm for the mission of the Church. The gospel as the proclamation of good news to the poor, the preaching of freedom for captives, of the recovery of sight for the blind, and the liberation of the oppressed became the criterion by which to assess how far the mission of today's church was really the continuation of the mission of Jesus of Nazareth.[11] The fact that some theologians opted for Marxist communism as the preferred socio-economic and political system for all nations should not prevent our recognizing the solid biblical grounding and the missionary value of this emphasis on Jesus' solidarity with the poor and oppressed as a model for the mission of the Church. As John Perkins says, the Church is called to Abe the replacement of Jesus in a given community, doing what he would do, going where he would go and teaching what he would teach".[12]

The Church and the cross of Jesus

The cross represents the culmination of the surrender of Jesus in submission to the will of God for the redemption of humankind. "He made him to be sin who knew no sin, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God" (2Co 5:21). This is at the very heart of the gospel. However, *the cross also represents the cost of discipleship and of faithfulness to God's call to take part in bringing to fruition his redemptive purpose*. The mission of the Church provides the

link between the death of Jesus Christ on the cross, on one hand, and the appropriation of the justice of God by faith "justification" on the other. As Paul states, the work of reconciliation contains two closely related aspects: God "reconciled us to himself through Christ, and has given us the ministry of reconciliation: that is in Christ God was reconciling the world to himself, not counting their trespasses against them, and entrusting the message of reconciliation to us" (2Co 5:18-19). The practice of the "ministry of reconciliation" has its cost, however, both in terms of sacrificial surrender for the sake of others "a self-giving which reproduces that of Jesus Christ" and also in terms of suffering for the sake of the gospel. The Church is not truly the Church unless it is, according to Bonhoeffer's description, "the Church for others", in which the image of "the man for others" is reproduced, the man who "came not to be served but to serve, and give his life a ransom for many" (Mk 10:45). Then too, when Jesus sent his disciples out on their mission during his earthly ministry, he warned them:

You will be hated by all because of my name. But the one who endures to the end will be saved ...A disciple is not above the teacher, nor a slave above the master; it is enough for the disciple to be like the teacher, and the slave like the master. If they have called the master of the house Beelzebul, how much more will they malign those of his household! (Mt 10:22, 24-25)

Suffering would be a constituent part of the disciples' mission, as it was for their Lord. It would not be fortuitous, or accidental. It would be the logical consequence of membership in the community of followers of the way of the Suffering Servant. So Paul would write to the faithful in Philippi:

Only live your life in a manner worthy of the gospel of Christ . . . striving side by side with one mind for the faith of the gospel, and in no way intimidated by your opponents. For them this is evidence of their destruction, but of your salvation. And this is God's doing. For he has graciously granted you the privilege, not only of believing in Christ, but of suffering for him as well (Php 1:27-29).

The cross was also the means whereby, according to Paul, Christ broke down the wall of separation between Jew and gentile, thus producing a new humanity, one body (Eph 2:14-16). The Church therefore is called to demonstrate, both in its life and in its message, this reconciliation with God and between individuals and groups. Among those who gather beneath the shadow of the cross of Christ, ethnic, social and gender divisions disappear so that "there is no longer Jew or Greek, slave or free, male or female," but "all of you are one in Christ Jesus" (Gal. 3:28). The Church provides a glimpse of a new humanity that in anticipation incarnates God's plan, that plan which will be brought to fruition in "the fullness of time", "to gather up all things, things in heaven and things on earth" in Christ (Eph 1:10).

The Church and the resurrection of Jesus

The carrying out of God's plan for the life and mission of the Church relies on one incomparable resource, the power with which God raised Jesus from the dead, the power of the resurrection. No wonder, then, that Paul in his prayer for the faithful asks God that they might experience the Aimmeasurable greatness" of that power (Eph 1:19-20).

The resurrection of Christ is the dawn of a new day in the story of salvation. It was the confirmation that his sacrifice had succeeded in overcoming the fatal consequence of sin, which is death. For those who put their trust in him, therefore, death does not have the last word. "The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law. But thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ!" (1Co 15:56, 57).

Because death has been vanquished, Christian hope in the final victory of God's plan is based on a solid foundation. The risen Christ is the first fruits of the great harvest, a new humanity. By his resurrection he has introduced into history a principle of life which guarantees not only the survival of the soul for all eternity, but also the permanent validation of all that the Church does through the power of the Spirit for the cause of Jesus Christ, that is, the cause of love and justice. That leads to Paul's exhortation, ATherefore my beloved, be steadfast, immovable, always excelling in the work of the Lord, because you know that in the Lord your labor is not in vain" (1Co 15:58). *The cause of Jesus Christ is the only cause that has a future.* So it makes sense to pray, "Thy kingdom come, thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven", and to strive that the power of the resurrection may become manifest in the here and now, and in every sphere of human life and in the whole of creation.

The Church and the exaltation of Jesus.

The close relation that exists between the present dimension of the Kingdom of God and the presence of the Holy Spirit who works in history to make the mission of the Church possible is clearly seen in Jesus' reply to a question posed by his close followers just before his ascension: "Lord, is this the time when you will restore the kingdom to Israel?" (Ac 1:6). Even after the crucifixion and the resurrection, two events which should have completely transformed the apostles' idea about the real nature of Jesus' mission, they are still clinging to those Jewish nationalist aspirations which had prompted them to follow Jesus from their first encounter and right up to the crucifixion of their Master. Jesus' reply does not seem to have much to do with the question. Rather, it sets in relief the combination of factors which are going to come into play in salvation history after the ascension of Jesus Christ. "It is not for you to know the times or periods that the Father has set by his own authority. But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of

the earth" (vv. 7-8). The following comments are germane.

First, according to Luke these are Jesus' final words before his ascension. They include the fifth account of the "Great Commission," [13] in which the missiology of the whole book of Acts is summarized in narrative form. Beginning in Jerusalem, the gospel spreads, first to the adjacent areas, Judea and Samaria, and then progresses until it arrives in Rome. In the whole process, the Church occupies a vital place, but not the Church alone: *the Church in the power of the Spirit.* The mission is no mere human project. It is the result of Jesus' mission being extended in history, an extension made possible by the action of the Holy Spirit. As such it is brought to fruition, not only by what the witnesses to Jesus *say*, but also by what they *are* and *do.*

Second, Pentecost follows immediately upon the ascension and is inseparable from it. Jesus Christ is enthroned as "Lord and Messiah" (Ac 2:36), King of the Universe, and from this position sends his Holy Spirit to equip the Church for the purpose of making disciples of all nations. The universal horizons of the mission are foreshadowed by the presence in Jerusalem of "devout Jews from every nation under heaven" (v. 5) on the day of Pentecost. The risen Christ, to whom the Church bears witness, has been anointed to reign and put his enemies under his feet. Peter explained it to the believers in his Pentecost sermon: "Being therefore exalted at the right hand of God, and having received from the Father the promise of the Holy Spirit, he has poured out this that you both see and hear. For David did not ascend into the heavens, but he himself says, 'The Lord said to my Lord: Sit at my right hand, until I make your enemies your footstool' (vv.33-35). Years later, in agreement with Peter, the apostle Paul will affirm "for he must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet" (1Co 15:25). With the exaltation of Jesus Christ and the coming of the Holy Spirit at Pentecost, a new era has been inaugurated in salvation history: the era of the Spirit, which is at the same time the era of Jesus Christ exalted as Lord and Messiah, and the era of the Church and her mission to make disciples in the power of the Spirit.

Thirdly, Jesus' promise to his apostles that he would be with them "always, to the end of the age" (Mt 28:20), a promise which accompanied his commission to make disciples of all nations, is fulfilled through the presence of the Spirit and the Word, the combination that made possible the existence of the Church and the success of her mission. As Emil Brunner says, "The *Ecclesia* is what it is through the presence of Christ dwelling within it. He is present in it through His Word and His Spirit".[14]

Finally, Acts 2:41-47 clearly shows that the result of the Pentecost experience is no ghetto-church, devoted to cultivating individualistic religion and an exclusive, separatist church. On the contrary, it is a community of the Spirit, a community that becomes a center of attention, "having the

good will of all the people" (v.47), because it incarnates the values of the Kingdom of God and affirms by its way of life the lordship of Jesus Christ over all of life, including economics. It is a missionary community which preaches reconciliation with God and the restoration of all creation by the power of the Spirit. It is a community which provides a glimpse of the birth of a new humanity, and in which can be seen, albeit Ain a mirror, dimly" (1Co 13:12), the actualization of God's plan for all humankind. "Although immersed in this world, the church by her way of being represents the promise of another world, which is not somewhere else but which is to come here."[15]

4. GIFTS AND MINISTRIES

Gifts and ministries are the means used by the Spirit of God to equip the Church as an agent of change in society 'change that reflects God's plan for human life and the whole creation' and to equip all the faithful for the fulfillment of their vocation as God's co-workers in the world.

The Church is essentially the eschatological community, the community of the end time, empowered by the Spirit to bear witness to the Lord Jesus Christ as Lord of everyone and everything. The empowerment is offered in the form of various gifts and ministries, which all members receive for the edification of the Body of Christ. As Paul says from his trinitarian perspective,

"Now there are varieties of gifts, but the same Spirit, and there are varieties of services, but the same Lord; and the are varieties of activities, but it is the same God who activates all of them in everyone" (1Co 12:4-6).

The importance of this statement for the articulation of an ecclesiology for integral mission cannot be exaggerated. And yet, all too frequently evangelical churches display a considerable deficiency in this area. The reasons for the deficiency are many and varied, but perhaps the most important is a tendency to reduce Christianity to a religion given over to the satisfaction of those needs most closely linked with the sacred and with worship services divorced from life. Seen in those terms, Christianity depends on "priests", who undertake the function of mediators between God and the faithful. From this standpoint the Church is a religious institution, managed by specialists in religious matters, primarily concerned with services of worship and the care of the "spiritual needs" of the people. There is a sharp distinction between "clergy" and "laity", between "religious life" and "daily living", and between "the sacred" and "the secular."

A vision of the whole Church with every member as an agent of integral mission, engaged in all areas of human life and creation, cannot possibly take root and flourish in a narrowly religious Christianity. Proof of that is to be found in the sad history of what were called "base Christian communities" that sprang up in several Latin American countries from the middle of the last century. What might have been

a genuine rebirth in the Church, "an authentic ecclesiogenesis" as Leonardo Boff called it,[16] deeply rooted in Scripture, in the heart of the Roman Catholic Church, developed into a threatening flame which had to be extinguished with every means at the Vatican's disposal. And it was practically extinguished.

It must be admitted that the New Testament does not provide answers for all the questions that can be asked about the Church and especially those concerned with institutional matters. That is the case with certain matters of church governance, which is an occasion of dissent among different Protestant denominations. But what is certain is that a New Testament perspective provides no basis for a hierarchical institution in which a small elite holds a monopoly of gifts and ministries, leaving the majority to limit themselves to "submitting" to their leaders.

Integral mission demands the "declericalization" of ministries and a "laicization" of the clergy. In other words, it requires a recognition of the apostolic nature of the whole Church. This implies, on one hand, that all members, by the simple fact of being disciples of Christ, share in the commission to go into the world in the name of Jesus Christ, as his witnesses. It also implies, on the other hand, that the leaders are a part of the *laos*, the people of God, just like all the rest of Christ's followers, no more and no less.

All this is in accordance with the biblical doctrine which formed one of the pillars of the Reformation of the sixteenth century, *the priesthood of all believers*. The classical reformers like Luther and Calvin, however, emphasized the *soteriological consequences* of that doctrine, namely that a person could have a direct relationship with God without the need for intermediaries. But they did not pay much attention to the *ecclesiological consequences*: that all believers are called to Christian ministry, whatever their vocation. In consequence, it was a common idea in the Protestant world that the benefits of salvation could be separated from the responsibility for mission. Integral mission demands the recovery of the priesthood of all believers to the extent that the Church become a community in which all members, equally, encourage each other to discover and develop their gifts and ministries in those countless areas of human existence which need transformation by the power of the gospel. As Boff says, the basic essential, without which the Church does not exist, is "faith in the active presence of the Risen One and of his Spirit at the heart of the whole human community, causing it to live out those fundamental values without which there is no humanity", and this leads to "accepting the co-responsibility of all in the building up of the Church, and not only some members of the clergy".[17]

What then is the place for the leaders of the Church? Is there no room for "specialized" ministries such as those exercised by the apostles, prophets,

evangelists, pastors and teachers referred to in Ephesians 4:11? There is nothing in what has been said so far which would preclude a positive answer to these questions: the risen and exalted Christ has distributed gifts and has established these ministries for the fulfilment of his plan. But this list of gifts (in this case person-gifts rather than special skills) needs to be seen alongside another three lists, two in 1 Corinthians 12 (vv. 7-11 and 28-30) and one in Romans 12 (vv. 6-8). Putting the four lists[18] together leads to the conclusion that there is no hierarchy of gifts or ministries; that all are valued equally, and that all have been conferred by "one and the same Spirit, who allots to each [member of the body of Christ] individually just as the Spirit chooses" (1Co 12.11). What is essential in the Church in carrying out her task as witness to Jesus Christ is not a hierarchy, but a community of gifts which complement each other and contribute equally to the common good. Peter's exhortation to the elders or "presbyters" (pastors) shows the extent to which there was a real longing to avoid that church leaders become dependent on formal rights of office, in exercising leadership in the community: "Tend the flock of God that is in your charge". Not under compulsion but willingly not for sordid gain, but *eagerly. Do not lord it over those in your charge, but be examples to the flock"* (1Pe 5:2-3, my italics). In the community of the Spirit two principles apply: the principle of service and the principle of teaching by example. These principles took flesh in Jesus Christ as basic norms for the exercise of power. The Church needs leaders, certainly, but leaders-servants; it needs teachers, but teachers-apprentices. As Guder puts it: "The organizational leadership of the church" is functional; that is, it is there to serve and equip the whole people for their ministry,"[19] Actually, Ephesians 4:11-12 indicates this when it says that person-gifts have been given to the Church "to equip the saints for the work of ministry, for building up the body of Christ".

Of course this is not to deny that the Church has to have an organizational or institutional structure. Brunner argues in *The Misunderstanding of the Church,* that the church-institution, characterized by institutional organization, resulting from centuries of ecclesiastical history, must not be confused with the *Ecclesia* of the New Testament, characterized by an order established by the Spirit.[20] For him an acknowledgment of this by all the churches would be the first step towards creating a greater sense of unity among them, for none of them would claim direct descent from the original *Ecclesia*, and all would see their need for continual reform. On the other hand, such an acknowledgment would remove one of the prime obstacles to the preservation of the true Church, because "the main enemy of the Christian message and the communion which is rooted in Christ is not the hostility of the unbelieving, but clerical, parsonic ecclesiasticism."[21]

Even so, toward the end of his stimulating book he suggests that it might well be God's will that new church structures "of a

very different order" could emerge in response to contemporary situations, structures which could favor the development of "the essence of the New Testament *Ecclesia* , the oneness of communion with Christ by faith and brotherhood in love."[22] Without rejecting Brunner's thesis, we need to add here that structures which favor "the unity of communion with Christ through faith and brotherhood in love" is just as necessary for the internal life of the Church as for her external life. The historical nature of the Church requires organization, but it is one thing to be organized for maintaining itself institutionally and ensuring survival, and something different to organize itself for integral mission, for collaboration with God in the fulfilment of his plan for human life and all creation. It is vital that the Church be structured for the task of integral mission. Without the working of God through the Spirit, organization will never ensure that the Church attain its goals as witness to Jesus Christ as Lord of everything and everyone. But what is also sure is that the lack of an adequate organization will militate against the development of the mission.

All churches are called to co-operate with God in the transformation of the world based on the gospel centered in Jesus Christ as Lord of the universe whose lordship provides the basis for an integral *ecclesiology* and an integral mission. The mission of the Church is the formation of disciples from all nations, disciples who are identified with Christ in his death and resurrection through baptism, and who are learning obedience to him in every aspect of life. The Church depends for its incarnate witness on the "saving events" through which Jesus brought about redemption, namely his life and ministry, his death on the cross, his resurrection and exaltation. Through the power of the Spirit, the Church constitutes the beginning of a new humanity, and in what it is, does and says bears witness to Jesus Christ and co-operates with God in the fulfilment of his plan. It is a community of gifts and ministries; a community of hope, faith and love; a community structured for the task of integral mission for the glory of God.

Chapter 2

Evangelism and the World

Overview

"The Gospel of Jesus Christ is a personal message -- it reveals a God who calls each of his own by name. But it is also a cosmic message -- it reveals a God whose purpose includes the whole world. . . The lack of appreciation of the broader dimensions of the gospel leads inevitably to a misunderstanding of the mission of the church."

Part One: The World in Biblical Perspective

1. "The world is the sum total of creation, the universe, 'the heavens and the earth' that God created in the beginning and that one day he will recreate."
2. "In a more limited sense, the world is the present order of human existence, the space-time context of (humanity's) life."
3. "The world is humanity, claimed by the gospel, but hostile to God and enslaved by the powers of darkness."

Part Two: Evangelism and Separation from the World

1. "Evangelism and the Proclamation of Jesus Christ as Lord of All"
2. "Evangelism and Worldliness"
   a. 'Secular Christianity'
   b. 'Culture Christianity'

      "The proclamation of Jesus Christ as Lord of all is a call to turn to God from idols, to serve a living and true God (I Thess. 1:9). Where there is no concept of the universal sovereignty of God there is no repentance, and where there is no repentance there is no salvation. Christian salvation is, among other things, liberation from the world as a closed system, from the world that has room only for a God bound by sociology, from the 'consistent' world that rules out God's free, unpredictable action."

Part Three: Evangelism and Involvement with the World

1. "Evangelism and Repentance Ethics"
2. "Evangelism and 'Otherworldliness'"
   a. "In the first place, for Jesus Christ himself the mission entrusted to him by the Father was not limited to preaching the gospel. (Matt 4:23, cf. 9:35)"
   b. "In the second place, Jesus' work had a social and political dimension."
   c. "In the third place, the new creation in Jesus Christ becomes history in terms of good works." "In the light of the biblical teaching, there is no place for an 'otherworldliness' that does not result in the Christian's commitment to neighbor, rooted in the gospel."

Chapter 2

Evangelism and the World

The gospel of Jesus Christ is a personal message—it reveals a God who calls each of his own by name. But it is also a cosmic message—it reveals a God whose purpose includes the whole world It is not addressed to the individual per se but to the individual as a member of the old humanity in Adam, marked by sin and death, whom God calls to be integrated into the new humanity in Christ, marked by righteousness and eternal life.

The lack of appreciation of the broader dimensions of the gospel leads inevitably to a misunderstanding of the mission of the church. The result is an evangelism that regards the individual as a self-contained unit—a Robinson Crusoe to whom God's call is addressed as to one on an island—whose salvation takes place exclusively in terms of a relationship with God. It i tint seen that the individual does not exist in isolation, and consequently that it is not possible to speak of salvation with no reference to the world of which he is a part.

In his high priestly prayer, Jesus Christ pleaded thus for his disciples: "I am no more in the world, but they are in the world, and I am coming to thee. . . . I do not pray that thou shouldst take them out of the world, but that thou shouldest keep them from the evil one. They are not of the world, even as I am not of the world" (John 17:11, 15-16). The paradox of Christian discipleship in relation to the world is placed before us—to be *in* the world but not to be of the world. This essay may be regarded as an attempt to explain the meaning of that paradox in its bearing on evangelism. The study is divided into three parts. The first is an analysis of the various stages of the term *world* in the New Testament. The second shows in what sense evangelism deals with a separation from the world, inasmuch as the disciples of Christ are not of the world. The third, finally, views evangelism from the perspective of involvement with the world, an involvement that reflects the fact that the disciples of Christ are *in* the world.

PART ONE: THE WORLD IN BIBLICAL PERSPECTIVE

A simple observation of the important place that the term world (Greek: cosmos) has in the New Testament (especially in the Johannine and Pauline writings and passages relating to the history of salvation) should suffice to demonstrate

the cosmic dimension of the gospel. God's work in Jesus Christ deals directly with the world as a whole, not simply with the individual. Thus, a soteriology that does not take into account the relationship between the gospel and the world will not do justice to the teaching of the Bible.

But what is the world?

I cannot here attempt an exhaustive study of the topic, but by way of introduction I will try briefly to sort out the various strands of meaning of the complex term cosmos in the New Testament.

1. The world is the sum total of creation, the universe, "the heavens and the earth" that God created in the beginning and that one day he will recreate.[1]

What is most distinctive in the New Testament concept of the universe is its Christological emphasis. The world was created by God through the Word (John 1: 10), and without him nothing that has been made was made (John 1:3). The Christ whom the gospel proclaims as the agent of redemption is also the agent of God creation. And he is at the same time the goal toward which all creation is directed (Col. 1: 16) and the principle of coherence of all reality, material and spiritual (Col. 1: 17).

In light of the universal significance of Jesus Christ, the Christian cannot be pessimistic concerning the final destiny of the world. In the midst of the changes of history, he knows that God has not abdicated his throne and that at the proper time, all things will be placed under the rule of Christ (Eph.1:10; cf.1Cor. 15:24ff.).[2] The gospel implies the hope of "a new heaven and a new earth" (Rev. 21 cf. 2 Pet. 3: 13). Consequently, the only true evangelism is that which is oriented toward that final goal of "the restoration of all things" in Christ Jesus promised by the prophets and proclaimed by the apostles (Acts 3:21). Eschatology centered in the future salvation of the soul turns out to be too limited in the face of secular eschatologies of our day, the most important of which—the Marxist—looks forward to the establishment of the ideal society and the creation of a new man. Today more than ever the Christian hope in its fullest dimensions must be proclaimed with such conviction and with such force that the falseness of every other hope should not have to be demonstrated.

2. In a more limited sense, the world is the present order of human existence, the space-time context of man's life.[3]

This is the world of material possessions, in which men are concerned for "things" that are necessary but that easily become an end in themselves (Luke 12:30). "Anxiety" for these things is incompatible with seeking the Kingdom of God (Luke 12:22-31). The treasures that man can store up on earth are perishable (Matt. 6:

19). It is useless for him to gain "the whole world" and lose or forfeit his own self (Luke 9:25; cf. John 12:25). There is a Christian realism that demands that we take seriously the fact that "we brought nothing into the world, and we cannot take anything out of the world" (1 Tim. 6:7). All material possessions lie under the sign of the transitoriness of a world that advances inexorably toward the end. In light of the end, everything that belongs solely to the present order becomes relative it cannot be considered the totality of human existence (1 Cor. 7: 29-31; cf. 1 John 2:17). To the contrary, it forms part of the system of man's rebellion against God (to which we will return later in this study).

To proclaim the gospel is to proclaim the message of a Kingdom that is not of this world (John 18: 36) the politics of which cannot for that reason conform to the politics of the kingdoms of this world. This is a Kingdom whose sovereign rejected "the kingdoms of the world and their glory" (Matt. 4:8, cf. Luke 4: 5) in order to establish his own Kingdom on the basis of love. It is a Kingdom that is made present among men, here and now (Matt. 12:28), in the person of one who does not come from this world (*tou cosmou toutou*) but "from above," from an order beyond the transitory scene of human existence (John 8: 23).

3. The world is humanity, claimed by the gospel, but hostile to God and enslaved by the powers of darkness [4].

Occasionally *cosmos* denotes humanity, with no reference to its position before God.[5] Much more frequently, though, it denotes humanity in its relation to the history of salvation that culminates in Jesus Christ, by whom it is judged.

a. *The world claimed by the gospel*. The most categorical affirmation of God's will to save the world is made in the person and work of his Son Jesus Christ. Let us not deny the universal scope of New Testament Soteriology just because we are unable to explain how it is that not all are saved even though it is God's will that his salvation reach all men (1 Tim. 2: 4). Ac cording to the New Testament, Jesus Christ is not the Savior of a sect but rather "the Savior of the world" (John 4: 42, 1 John 4: 14, 1 Tim. 4: 10). The world is the object of God's love (John 3: 16). Jesus Christ is the Lamb of God that takes away the sin of the world (John 1: 29), the light of the world (John 1:9' 8: 12, 9:5), the propitiation not only for the sins of his own people but "also for the sins of the whole world" (1 John 2: 2, cf. 2 Cor. 5: 19). To this end he was sent by the Father—not to condemn the world, but "that the world might be saved through him" (John 3: 17).

Obviously God's salvation in Christ Jesus is universal in scope. But the universality of the gospel must not be confused with the universalism of contemporary theologians who hold that on the basis of the work of Christ all men have received eternal life, whatever their position before

Christ. The benefits obtained by Christ are inseparable from the gospel and, consequently, can be received only *in* and *through* the gospel. To preach the gospel is not merely to proclaim an accomplished fact, but simultaneously to proclaim the accomplished fact and make a call to faith. The proclamation of Jesus as "the Savior of the world" is not an affirmation that all men are automatically saved but rather an invitation to all men to put their confidence in the one who gave his life for the sin of the world. "Christ does not save us apart from faith, faith does not restore us apart from Christ. He became one with us, we have to become one with him. Without the affirmation of this double process of self-identification and of the results that follow it, there is no complete exposition of the gospel."[6]

From the universality of the gospel is derived the universality of the evangelizing mission of the church. The gospel's film on the world, initiated in Jesus Christ, is continued through his followers. As the Father sent him, so he has sent them into the world (John 17:18). Repentance and forgiveness of sin in his name must be announced to all nations (Luke 24:47, cf. Matt 28:l9 Mark 16:15). And it is this demand of the gospel that gives meaning to history until the end of the present era (Matt. 24:14).

b. The *world hostile to God and enslaved by the powers of darkness.* The most distinctive usage of *cosmos* in the New Testament is predominately negative. It refers to humanity, but to humanity in open hostility to God: it is personified as the enemy of Jesus Christ and his followers. The Word through whom all things were made came into the world, but "the world knew him not" (John 1: 10). He came as the light of the world (John 8: 12, 9:5) to bear witness to the truth (John 18: 37), but "men loved darkness rather than light, because their deeds were evil" (John 3: 19). It was a collective rejection. But it was the only attitude consistent with the nature of the world alienated from God: the world cannot receive the Spirit of truth (John 14: 17) the carnal mind cannot submit to God's law (Rom. 8:7). This is the tragedy of the world: it is caught up in the vicious circle of a rejection that leads it to hate Christ and his followers (John 15: 18, 24; 1 John 3: 1, 13) and at the same time leaves it incapable of recognizing the truth of the gospel (John 9: 39-41). The condition of the world in its rebellion against God is such that Jesus Christ does not even pray for it (John 17:9).

But if we dig a bit deeper in our analysis of the concept of the world in the Johannine and Pauline writings, it becomes obvious that behind this rejection of Jesus Christ lies the influence of spiritual powers hostile to man and to God. "The whole world is in the power of the evil one" (1John 5:19). The "wisdom of the world," characterized by its ignorance of God, reflects the wisdom of "the rulers of this age" — the powers of darkness—that crucified Christ (1Cor.1:20, 2:6, 8). Unbelievers' blindness to the gospel is the result of the

action of Satan, “the god of this world” (2 Cor. 4:4). Apart from faith, men are in subjection to the spirit of the age (the Zeitgeist) controlled by the “prince of the power of the air” (Eph. 2:2). The world is under the domination of the “elemental spirits” (Gal. 4:3, 9; Col. 2:8,20), the principalities and powers (Rom. 8:38; 1 Cor. 15:24, 26; Eph. 1:21; 3:10; 6:12; Col. 1:16; 2:10, 15).

The picture of the world that emerges from the texts I have cited is confirmed by the rest of the New Testament. In it, as in first-century Judaism, the present age is conceived of as the period in which Satan and his hosts have received the authority to rule the world. The universe is not a closed system in which everything can be explained by an appeal to natural causes; rather, it is the arena in which God—a God who acts in history—is engaged in a battle with the spiritual powers that enslave men and hinder their perception of the truth revealed in Jesus Christ.

This diagnosis of man’s plight in the world cannot simply disliked as stemming out of the apocalyptic speculation that was common among the Jews of New Testament times. As Emil Stauffer says, “In primitive Christianity there is no theology without demonology.” And without demonology the answer to the problem of sin must be found exclusively in man, without giving due attention to the fact that man himself is the victim of an order that transcends him and imposes on him a detrimental way of life. Sin (singular) is not the sum total of the individual sins (plural) of man. It is, on the contrary, an objective situation that conditions men and forces them to commit sin: “Everyone who commits sin is a slave to sin” (John 8:34). The essence of sin is the lie (“You will be like God” — Gen. 3. 5), and lying has its origin in the devil, the “liar and father of lies” (John 8:44). Sin, then, is a social and even cosmic rather than merely an individual problem. Personal sins — those sins that according to Jesus come “from within, out of the heart of man” (Mark 7:21-2)—are the echo of a voice that comes from the creation, the creation that “was subjected to futility” and that will be “set free from its bondage to decay” (Rom. 8: 20-21).

Unfortunately, much too frequently it has been taken for granted that the concrete manifestation of satanic action among takes place primarily or even exclusively in those phenomena that fall within the sphere of demonic possession or the occult. Thus we have lost sight of the demonic nature of the while spiritual environment that conditions man’s thought and conduct. The individualistic concept of redemption is the theological consequence of an individualistic concept of sin that ignores “all that is in the world” (not simply in the heart of man) —namely, “the lust of the flesh and the lust of the eyes and the pride of life” (1 John 2:15-16). In one word it ignores the reality of *materialism*, which is to say the absolutization of the present age in all it offers—consumer goods, money, political power, philosophy,

science, social class, race, nationality, sex, religion, tradition, and so on the "collective egoism" (to borrow Niebuhr's phrase) that conditions man to seek his realization in "the desirable things" of life; the Great Lie that man derives his meaning from "being like God" in independence from God.

Under the domination of the powers of darkness, the world stands at the same time under the judgment of God. God sent his Son not to condemn the world but to offer it the possibility of salvation through him (John 3:17 cf. 12:47). Nevertheless, the world is judged by its rejection of the light of life that has made its appearance among men. "This is the judgment, that the light has come into the world, and men loved darkness rather than light, because their deeds were evil" (John 3: 19,cf. 12:48).

In conclusion, man's problem in the world is not simply that he commits isolated sins or gives in to the temptation of particular vices. It is, rather, that he is imprisoned within a closed system of rebellion against God, a system that conditions him to absolutize the relative and relativize the absolute, a system whose mechanism of self-sufficiency deprives him of eternal lie and subject him to the judgment of God.

This is one reason that evangelism cannot be reduced to the verbal communication of doctrinal content with no reference to specific forms of man's involvement in the world. It is also one of the reasons that the evangelist's confidence cannot rest in the efficacy of his methods. As the Apostle Paul taught, "We are not contending against flesh and blood, but against the principalities, against the powers, against the world rulers of this present darkness, against the spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places" (Eph. 6:12). The proclamation of the gospel does take seriously the necessity of divine resources for the battle.

PART TWO: EVANGELISM AND SEPARATION FROM THE WORLD

The gospel does not come from man, but from God. Its entrance into the world necessarily leads to conflict, because it questions the absolute nature of "the desirable things" of the old era. Its presence alone means crisis, because it demands that man discern between God and the false gods, between light and darkness, between truth and error. Those who bear the gospel, then, are "the aroma of Christ to God among those who are being saved and among those who are perishing, to one a fragrance from death to death, to the other a fragrance of life to life" (2 Cor. 2:15-16). The gospel unites, but it separates. And out of this separation created by the gospel springs the church as a community called to be not *of* the world but *in* the world.

The concept of the church as an entity "separated" from the world lends itself to all kinds of false interpretations. At the one

extreme is the position which holds that there is no real separation but only a simple epistemological difference: the church knows that it has been reconciled to God, while the world does not know—and that is all.[7] At the other extreme is the position which holds that the separation is an impassable chasm between two cities that communicate with each other only as the one sets out on a crusade to conquer the other. Our concept of the nature of the separation between the church and the world inevitably influences our definition of the gospel and our methods of evangelism. We urgently need to recover an evangelism that takes seriously the distinction between the church and the world as it is seen from the perspective of the gospel, an evangelism that is oriented toward breaking man's slavery in the world and does not itself become an expression of the church's enslavement to the world.

1. Evangelism and the Proclamation of Jesus Christ as Lord of All

A brief study of the New Testament is sufficient to show that the essentials of its message are summarized in the oldest creed of the church: "Jesus Christ is the *Kyrios*." Though it is trite that only after the resurrection were the disciples able to grasp the importance of this title as applied to Jesus Christ, there is no doubt that for them the one whom God had made 14 and Christ" was none other than the Jesus who had been crucified (Acts 2:36). To say that Jesus Christ is Lord is to say that the same Jesus whom God put forward "as a propitiatory offering by his blood" (Rom. 3:25) is now "Lord of all" (Rom. 10: 12). Having provided the basis for the forgiveness of sin through the sacrifice of himself, he has occupied the place that is rightly his as mediator in the government of the world (Heb. 1:4).

On the basis of the texts mentioned, to which several others could be added, it is obvious that it is impossible to separate the priestly ministry of Jesus Christ from his kingly ministry. From the New Testament perspective, the work of God in his Son, cannot be limited to cleansing from the guilt of sin; it is also a liberation from the powers of darkness, a transference to the messianic Kingdom which, in anticipation of the end, has been made present in Christ (Col. 1: 13). The Christ who wrought forgiveness of sins is also the Christ who wrought liberation from slavery to the world. The hour of the Cross was the hour of the judgment of this world and of its "ruler" (John 12: 31 16:11), the hour in which Christ disarmed the principalities and powers and proclaimed their defeat, leading them as prisoners in a triumphal parade (Col. 2: 15). Jesus Christ has been exalted as the Kyrios of all the universe (Eph. 1: 20-22 Phil. 2:9-11; 1 Pet. 3:22), and it is as such that he is able to save all those who call on his name (Rom. 10:12-13). Salvation in Christ involves both forgiveness of sin (1 John 1:9) and victory over the world (John 5: 4) by faith.

To evangelize, then, is not to offer an experience of freedom from feelings of

guilt, as if Christ were a super-psychiatrist arid his saving power could be separated from his Lordship. To evangelize is to proclaim Christ Jesus as Lord and Savior, by whose work man is delivered from both the guilt and the power of sin and integrated into God's plans to put all things under the rule of Christ. As Walter Künneth has pointed out, an individualistic Christology — a Christology that views Christ only in his relation to the individual—leaves the door open to a denial of creation, for the world must then be understood as if it existed apart from the Word of God which gives it meaning.[8] The Christ proclaimed by the gospel is the Lord of all, in whom God has acted decisively in history in order to form a new humanity. The one who places his confident *in him* is delivered from "the present evil age" (Gal. 1:4) and from the powers by which it is characterized; the world is crucified to him, and he to the world (Gal. 1:4) and from the powers by which it is characterized; the world is crucified to him, and he to the world (Gal. 6:4); he cannot submit to false gods as if he still belonged to the sphere of their influence (Col. 2:20).

Obviously, the separation of the church from the world can take place only from a theological, eschatological perspective. It is *before God* that the church takes shape as a community that belongs not to the present age but to the coming age. By vocation, it is not *of* the world in the sense that it has rejected the Great Lie implicit in materialism (with its absolutization of "the desirable things" that the world offers). Though the old era is under the dominion of idols that set themselves up as gods and lords, the church holds that there is only one God, the Father, and one Lord, Jesus Christ, the mediator of creation and of redemption (1Cor. 8:5-6). Here and now, in anticipation of the universal recognition of Jesus Christ as Lord of all creation (Phil. 2:9-11), the church has received him (Eph. 1:22) and lives by virtue of the blessings and gifts which he as Lord bestows (Eph. 1:3-1 4 4:7-16). This is the basic difference between the church and the world.

Without the proclamation of Jesus Christ as Lord of all, there is no true evangelism. To evangelize is to proclaim Jesus Christ as the one who is reigning today and who will continue to reign "until he has put all his enemies under his feet" (1Cor.15:25), New Testament cosmic Christology is an essential element of the gospel proclamation.

2. Evangelism and Worldliness

On the Cross Jesus Christ inflicted a decisive defeat on the ruler of this world. The enemy has been mortally wounded. The resurrection has demonstrated that the futility to which the creation is subjected does not mean that God has abdicated his rule over it. All creation will be delivered from its bondage to decay

(Rom. 8:20-21); the whole universe will be placed under the rule of Christ (Eph. 1:10).

Hope in the final triumph of Jesus Christ belongs to the essence of the Christian faith, what did through the death and resurrection of his Son he will complete at the end of time.

We cannot, however, fool ourselves about the actual historic situation of the church in relation to the world. A rapid reading of the New Testament points out the crude reality of the conditioning that the world and 'the things that are in the world" exercise over man, whether Christian or not. The victory of Christ over the world and the powers is not a mere doctrine requiring intellectual assent, it is a fact that must be come concrete reality in Christian experience through faith. To Jesus' claim "1 have overcome the world" (John 16:33) corresponds the believer's "victory that overcomes the world, our faith" (1John 5: 4). In other words, Christ is called to *become* what he already is. The imperative of the evangelical ethic forms an indivisible whole with the indicative of the gospel.

As long as the present age endures, the battle against the powers of darkness continues. Worldliness never ceases to be a threat to the church and its evangelizing mission. In spite of having been delivered from the present evil age (Gal. 1: 4), Christians run the risk of returning to the "weak and beggarly elemental spirits" to which this age is subject (Gal. 4: 9), the risk of submitting themselves to slavery to human regulations ("Do not handle, do not taste, do not touch") as if they were still of the world (Col. 2: 20-22). For this reason, Christians need to be reminded of the liberty that has been given them in Christ. Because he died and rose again, the way has been opened to live here and now in the liberty of the children of God that belongs to the new era. All legalism is, therefore, worldliness—a return to slavery to the powers of darkness. And this is applicable to the prohibitions and taboos that today in many places in the world are part of the "evangelical sub culture" and that are often so confused with the gospel that evangelism becomes a call to observe certain religious rules and practices and loses its meaning as proclamation of the message of liberty.

Another form in which worldliness enters the life and mission of the church today is the adaptation of the gospel to the "spirit of the times." Because of the limits of space, I will cite only two examples.

a. "*Secular Christianity*." Already in the first century an attempt was made to accommodate the gospel to the dualism between spirit and matter that was part of the ideological atmosphere of the day. Thus developed what in the history of Chris thought is known as "Docetism": in the face of a dualistic interpretation of the world, a *new* Christology was proposed that would make the gospel acceptable to those who could not conceive of the possibility that God (good by nature)

should thin into direct relation with matter (evil by nature). Such seems to be the heresy to which the Epistles of John refer.

The problem today is not the dualism between spirit and matter, but rather secularism—the concept that the natural would represents the totality of reality and thus that the only possible knowledge is the "scientific." It is the logical consequence of another type of dualism, one derived from the philosophy of Descartes—the dualism between man (the thinking subject) and the world (the object of thought).[9] There is no place for God as the transcendent being who has the power to act in history and in nature. All that exists or happens in the universe can be explained by the laws of cause and effect, what cannot be investigated by empirical methods cannot be real.

All the versions of "secular Christianity" advocated by modern theologians assume the validity of secularism, sometimes under the garb of mere "secularity." They all take as their starting point a world in which man has supposedly come of age (as seen by Dietrich Bonhoeffer) and has no need for supernatural reality, the basic premise of religion. Their purpose is "a re-statement of the gospel for this modern man who has learned to get along in the world and now presumes that he no need of supernatural help. The end of "supernaturalism," the end of that old doctrine of transcendence which is part and parcel of a pre-scientific concept of the universe, has arrived. If the Christian faith is to survive, it must be brought up to date it must throw off every residue of "transcendentalism" and express itself in secular terms, so that no thinking man has to reject it together with accompanying pre-scientific ideas. Far from being an enemy of the Christian faith, secularism is an ally, since (as Friedrich Gogarten has argued) man's responsibility for the world is the very essence of the gospel.

Thus the foundation is laid for man to concentrate all his effort in building the earthly city without having to concern himself with reality "beyond" or "above" the natural realm. Man is the author of his own destiny, and his vocation is exclusively historical.

Robert J. Blaikie has demonstrated in detail that in the Cartesian system of reality that underlies "secular Christianity" there really is no place for the concept of man as an 'agent"— a person capable of acting freely and introducing intentional changes in the world.[10] Action is the basic characteristic of personal reality. But if man is no more than the thinking subject and the world only the object of his thought, completely determined within a closed system of causes and effects, it follows that man is not personal reality and cannot be considered an active agent. Common sense tells us, nevertheless, that we are in fact beings living and acting in the world and that the concept of reality as something that can only be known "objectively" by means of the scientific method is incomplete, a view based on

philosophical premises that, as such, cannot be proven scientifically. In conclusion, "secular Christianity" is not a mere "restatement" of the gospel, but rather a capitulation to a distorted concept of reality that is part of modern secularism.

Man's responsibility for creation is an essential aspect of his vocation according to the biblical definition, the exclusion of God (i. e., the personal God who acts in nature and in human history) is a compromise with "the spirit of the age." It is a form of worldliness. "Secular Christianity" is a man-centered religion that says only what man wants to hear—that he is his own boss, that the future is in his hands, that God is merely something impersonal that he can manipulate. It is a denial of the biblical message, the basic presupposition of which is that God transcends the universe and acts freely within it.

In the final analysis, what "secular Christianity" does is sanctify the secular, replacing God's love manifested in Jesus Christ with the love for the *things* of the secular city, as if the present order to which they belong had absolute value. John's admonition to a *first* century church threatened by Docetism is relevant today: "Do not love the world or the things in the world. If any one loves the world, love for the Father is not in him" (1John 2: 15).

b. "Culture Christianity." No less harmful to the cause of the gospel than "secular Christianity" is the identification of Christianity with a culture or a cultural expression. In the sixteenth century, Latin America was conquered in the name of the Catholic king and queen of Spain. This conquest was not only military but religious as well. It was concerned with implanting not merely Spanish culture but a "Christian culture." Only in recent years has Rome become aware that the Christianity of the people of Latin America is almost purely nominal. In the nineteenth century, the Christian missionary outreach was so closely connected with European colonialism that in Africa and Asia Christianity became identified as the white man's religion.

Today, however, there is another form of "culture Christianity" that has come to dominate the world scene—"the American Way of Life." This phenomenon is described by a North American Christian writer in these terms: "A major source of the rigid equation of socio-political conservatism with evangelicalism is conformity with the world. We have equated Americanism with Christianity to such an extent that we are tempted to believe that people in other cultures must adopt American institutional patterns when they are converted. We are led through natural psychological processes to an unconscious belief that the essence of our American Way of Life is basically, if not entirely, Christian."[11] This equation in the United States insures the presence of a large number of middle- class whites in the church. But the price the church has had to pay for quantity is its prophetic role

in society. What Tillich called "the Protestant principle" (i.e., the capacity to denounce every historic absolutization) is impossible for 'culture Christianity." And this explains the confusion of Christian orthodoxy with socio-economic and political conservatism among evangelicals in the United States.

Because of the powerful influence that this type of Christianity has had in what is known as "the mission field," the gospel that is preached today in the majority of countries of the world bears the marks of "the American Way of Life." It is not surprising that at least in Latin America today the evangelist often has to face innumerable prejudices that reflect the identification of Americanism with the gospel in the minds of his listeners. The image of a Christian that has .been projected by some forms of United States Christianity is that of a successful businessman who has found the formula for happiness, a formula he wants to share with others freely. The basic problem is that in a market of "free consumers" of religion in which the church has no possibility of maintaining its monopoly on religion, this Christianity has resorted to reducing its message to a minimum in order to make all men want to become Christians. The gospel thus becomes a type of merchandise the acquisition of which guarantees to the consumer the highest values —success in life and personal happiness now and forever. The act of "accepting Christ" is the means to reach the ideal of "the good life" at no cost. The Cross has lost its offense, since it simply points to the sacrifice of Jesus Christ for us but does not present a call to discipleship. The God of this type of Christianity is the God of "cheap grace", the God who constantly gives but never demands, the God fashioned expressly for mass-man, who is con trolled by the law of least possible effort and seeks easy solutions, the God who gives his attention to those who will not reject him because they need him as an analgesic.

In order to gain the greatest possible number of followers, it is not enough for "culture Christianity" to turn the gospel into a product, it also has to distribute it among the greatest number of consumers of religion. For this, the twentieth century has provided it with the perfect tool—technology. The strategy for the evangelization of the world thus becomes a question of mathematical calculation. The problem is to produce the greatest number of Christians at the least possible cost in the shortest possible time, and for this the strategists can depend on the work of the computer. Thanks to computers, never in the modern era have we been closer to the reestablishment of one culture unified by the Christian faith—the *Corpus Christianum*. The "culture Christianity" of our day has at its. disposal the most sophisticated technological resources to propagate its message of success throughout the world and to do it efficiently!

Obviously, what is objectionable in this approach to evangelism is not the use of technology in itself. Viewed alone, technology, like science or money, is morally neutral. Nor is the concern that there be more Christians in the world to be questioned. God "desires all men to be saved and to come to the knowledge of the truth" (1Tim. 2:4). The problem with this "culture Christianity" lies in the fact that it reduces the gospel to a formula for success and equates the triumph of Christ with obtaining the highest number of "conversions." This is a man-centered Christianity that clearly shows itself to be conditioned by the "technological mentality" — that mentality that, as Jacques Ellul has pointed out, regards efficiency as the absolute criterion and on this basis seeks, in all areas of human life, the systematization of methods and resources to obtain reestablished results.[1] It is the "religious" product of a civilization which nothing, not even man himself, escapes technology -- a civilization obsessed with its search for the "one best way," which inevitably leads to automation. This is another form of worldliness. The manipulation of the gospel to achieve successful results inevitably leads to slavery to the world and its powers.

As is the case with "secular Christianity," the basic question in relation to "culture Christianity" is the very significance of the gospel. I am afraid, nevertheless, that the proponents of this type of Christianity are those least able to see the problem, since the majority of them live in the land where the techno logical mentality exerts its greatest influence. It is not surprising that any criticism of this approach to evangelism should fall on deaf ears or be interpreted as a lack of interest in the propagation of the gospel. At this rate we may ask if the day is not close when missionary strategists employ B. F. Skinner's 'behavior conditioning"[13] and "Christianize" the world through the scientific control of environmental conditions and human genetics.

The proclamation of Jesus Christ as Lord of all is a call to turn to God from idols, to serve a living and true God (1Thess. 1:9). Where there is no concept of the universal sovereignty of God there is no repentance, and where there is no repentance there is no salvation. Christian salvation is, among other things, liberation from the world as a closed system, from the world that has room only for a God bound by sociology, from the "consistent" world that rules out God's free, unpredictable action. One cannot be a friend of this world without being an enemy of God (James 4:4). To love this world is to reject the love of God (1John 2: 15). The gospel, then, is a call not only to faith but also to repentance, to a break with the world. And it is only in the extent to which we are free from this world that we are able to serve our fellow men.

PART THREE: EVANGELISM AND INVOLVEMENT WITH THE WORLD

The Kingdom of God has arrived in the person of Jesus Christ. Eschatology has

invaded history. God has clearly ex pressed his plan to place all things under the rule of Christ. The powers of darkness have been defeated. Here and now, in union with Jesus Christ, man has within his reach the blessings of the new era.

However, the Kingdom of God has not yet arrived in all its fullness. Our salvation is "in hope" (Rom. 8: 24). According to God's promise, "we wait for new heavens and a new earth righteousness dwells" (2Pet. 3: 13). Ours is the time of the patience of God, who does not wish "that any should perish, but that all should reach repentance (2Pet. 3:9).

1. Evangelism and Repentance Ethics

The gospel is always proclaimed in opposition to an organized lie —the Great Lie that man realizes himself by pretending to be God, in autonomy from God that his life consists in the he possesses, that he lives for himself alone and is the owner of his destiny. All history is the history of this Lie and the destruction it has brought upon man—the history if how man (as C. S. Lewis would aptly express it) has enjoyed the horrible liberty he has demanded and consequently has been enslaved.

The gospel involves a call to repentance from this Lie. The relation between the gospel and repentance is such that preach M the gospel is equivalent to preaching "repentance and forgiveness of sins" (Luke 24: 47) or to testifying "of repentance to God and of faith in our Lord Jesus Christ" (Acts 20:21). Without this call to repentance there is no gospel. And repentance involves not merely a bad conscience—the "worldly grief" that produces death (2Cor. 7: 10)—but a change of attitude, a restructuring of one's scale of values, a reorientation of the whole of one's personality. It is not simply giving up habits condemned by a moralistic ethic but rather laying down the weapons of rebellion against God in order to return to him. It is not simply recognizing a psychological necessity but rather accepting the Cross of Christ as death to the world in order to live before God.

This call to repentance throws into relief the social dimension of the gospel. It comes to man enslaved by sin in a specific social situation, not to a "sinner" in the abstract. It is a change of attitude that becomes concrete in history. It is a turning from sin to God not only in the individual's subjective consciousness but *in the world*. This truth is clearly illustrated in John the Baptist's proclamation of the Kingdom (Matt. 3:1-12; Luke 3:7-14), concerning which I will simply make the following observations. (1) It has a strong eschatological note. The time of fulfillment of God's promises given through his prophets has come. The presence of Jesus Christ among men is the evidence that God is active in history to accomplish his purposes: "The kingdom of heaven is at hand" (Matt. 3: 2). (2) This new reality places men in a position of crisis, they cannot continue to live as if nothing had happened, the Kingdom of God demands

a new mentality, a reorientation of all their values, repentance (Matt.3:2). Repentance has an eschatological significance: it marks the boundary between the old age and the new, between judgment and promise. (3) The change imposed involves a new lifestyle: “Bear fruits that befit repentance’ (Luke 3:8). Without ethics there is no real repentance. (4) Repentance ethics is more than generalizations, it has to do with specific acts of self-sacrifice in concrete situati9ns. To each one who becomes convicted by his message, John the Baptist has a fitting word, and in each case his ethical demand touches the point at which the man is enslaved to the powers of the old age and closed to God’s action. To the people in general he says, “He who has two coats, let him share with him who has none, and he who has food, let him do likewise.” To the tax collectors he says, “Collect no more than is appointed you.” To the soldiers he says, “Rob no one by violence or by false accusation, and be content with your wages” (Luke 3:11-14). The crisis created by the Kingdom cannot be resolved by accepting concepts handed down by tradition (“We are descendants of Abraham”), it must be resolved by obedience to the ethics of the Kingdom.

Where there is no concrete obedience there is no repentance, and without repentance there is no salvation (Mark 1: 4 Luke 13:3 Matt. 21:32, Acts 2:38, 3: 19, 5:31). Salvation is man’s return to God, but it is at the same time also man’s return to his neighbor. In the presence of Jesus Christ, Zacchaeus the publican renounces the materialism that has enslaved him and accepts responsibility for his neighbor: “Behold, Lord, the half of my goods I give to the poor, and if I have defrauded anyone of anything, I restore it fourfold” (Luke 19:8). This renunciation and this commitment Jesus calls salvation: “Today salvation has come to this house” (Luke 19:9). Zacchaeus’s response to the gospel call could not be expressed in more concrete or “worldly” terms. It is not merely a subjective experience, it is a moral experience as well—an experience that affects his life precisely at that point at which the Great Lie had taken root, an experience that brings him out of himself and turns him toward his neighbor.

The gospel message, since it was first proclaimed by Jesus lit involves a call to repentance (Matt. 4:17). Repentance is much more than a private affair between the individual and God It is the complete reorientation of life in the world— d lug men—in response to the work of God in Jesus Christ. When evangelism does not take repentance seriously, it is because it does not take the world seriously, and when it does not take the world seriously it does not take God seriously. The gospel is not a call to social quietism. Its goal is not to take a man out of the world but to put him into it, no longer as a slave but as a son of God and a member of the body of Christ.

If Jesus Christ is Lord, men must be confronted with his authority over the

totality of life. Evangelism is not and cannot be, a mere offer of benefits achieved by Jesus Christ. Christ's work is inseparable from his person, the Jesus who died for our sins is the Lord of the whole universe, and the announcement of forgiveness in his name is inseparable from the call to repentance, the call to turn from "the rulers of this world" to the Lord of glory. But "no one can say Jesus is Lord except by the Holy Spirit" (1Cor. 12:3).

2.Evangelism and "Otherworldliness"

To secular Christianity," obsessed with the life of this world, the only salvation possible is one that fits within the limits of this present age. It is essentially an economic, social, and political salvations, although sometimes (as in the case of the Latin American "liberation theology") an attempt is made to extend the concept to include "the making of a new man," the author of his own destiny.[14] Eschatology is absorbed by Utopia, and the Christian hope becomes confused with the worldly hope proclaimed by Marxism.

At the other extreme is the concept of salvation as the future salvation of the soul, in which present life has meaning only as a preparation for the "hereafter." History is assimilated by a futurist eschatology, and religion becomes a means of escape from present reality. The result is a total withdrawal from the problems of society in the name of "separation from the world." It is this misunderstanding of the gospel that has given rise to the Marxist criticism of Christian eschatology as the "opiate of the people."

That this concept of salvation is a misunderstanding of biblical Soteriology should not have to be demonstrated. Unfortunately, it is a concept rooted so deep in the preaching of so many evangelical churches that we must stop to analyze the question.

In the first place, for Jesus Christ himself the mission en trusted to him by the Father was not limited to preaching the gospel. Matthew for example, summarizes Jesus' earthly ministry in these words: "And he went about all Galilee, teaching in their synagogues and preaching the gospel of the kingdom and healing every disease and every infirmity among the people" (Matt. 4: 23; cf. 9: 35). Even if evangelism is defined solely in terms of verbal communication—a definition that would leave much to be desired in light of the psychology of communication — we still must add, on the basis of the text, that evangelism was only one of the elements of Jesus' mission. Together with the *kerygma* went the d*iakonia* and the *didache.* This presupposes a concept of salvation that includes the whole man and cannot be reduced to the simple forgiveness of sins and assurance of unending life with God in heaven. A comprehensive mission corresponds to a comprehensive view of salvation. Salvation is wholeness. Salvation is total humanization. Salvation is eternal life, the

life of the Kingdom of God, life that begins here and now (this is the meaning of the present tense of the verb "has eternal life" in the Gospel and the Epistles of John) and touches all aspects of man's being.

In the second place, Jesus' work had a social and political dimension. The individualism of "culture Christianity" to which I have referred above sees the Lord with only one eye, as an individualistic Jesus who is concerned with the salvation of individuals. An unprejudiced reading of the Gospels shows us cii', who, in the midst of many political alternatives (Pharisaism, Sadduceeism, Zealotism, Essenism), personifies and proclaims a new alternative—the Kingdom of God. To say that Jesus is the Christ is to describe him in political terms, to affirm that he is *king*. His Kingdom is not of this world—not in the sense that it does not adapt itself to human politics. It is a Kingdom with its own politics, marked by sacrifice. Jesus is a king who "came not to be served but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many" Mark 10:45). This service to the point sacrifice belongs to the very essence of his mission. And this must be a distinctive sign of the community that acknowledges him as king. According to the politics of man, "those who are supposed to rule over the Gentiles lord it over them, and their great men exercise authority over them;" in the politics of the Kingdom of God, he who wants to be great "must be slave of all" (Mark 10:43-44). Thus Jesus confronts the power structures by denouncing their deep-seated ambition to rule and by proclaiming another alternative, based on love, service, dedication to others. He does not take refuge in "religion" or "spiritual things," as if his Kingdom had nothing to do with political and social life; rather, he demythologizes the politics of man and presents himself as the Servant-King, the creator and model of a community that submits to him as Lord and commits itself to live as he lived. The concrete result of Jesus' sacrifice for the sake of others, the culmination of which was reached in the Cross, is this community patterned after the Servant-King: a community in which each member gives according to his means and receives according to his needs, since "it is more blessed to give than to receive" (Acts 2:45; 4:34-35; 20:35), a community in which racial, cultural, social, and even thaI harriers disappear, since "Christ is all, and in all" (Col. 3:11, Gal. 3:28) a community of reconciliation with God and reconciliation among men (Eph. 2:11-22) and a community, finally, that serves as a base for the resistance against the conditioning of "the present evil age" and makes it possible for Jesus' disciples to live *in* the world without being *of* the world.

In the third place, the new creation in Jesus Christ becomes history in terms of good works. In Paul's words, God has "created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them" (Eph. 2:10). Jesus Christ "gave himself for us to redeem us from all iniquity and to purify for himself a

people of his own who are zealous for good deeds" (Titus 2:14). The New Testament knows nothing of a gospel that makes a divorce between Soteriology and ethics, between communion with God and communion with one's neighbor, between faith and works. The Cross is not only the negation of the validity of every human effort to gain God's favor by works of the law, it is also the demand for a new quality of life characterized by love—the opposite of an individualistic life centered on personal ambitions and indifferent to the needs of others. The significance of the Cross is both soteriological and ethical. This is so because in choosing the Cross Jesus not only created the indicative of the gospel ("By this we know love, that he laid down his life for us" — 1 John 3:16a) but also simultaneously provided the pattern for human life here and now ("And we ought to lay down our lives for the brethren"— I John 3: I6b). Just as the Word became man, so also must love become good works if it is to be intelligible to men. This is what gives meaning to "worldly goods": they can be converted into instruments through which the life of the new age expresses itself. This is what John means when he says, "If anyone has the world's goods and sees his brother in need, yet closes his heart against him, how does God's love abide in him? Little children, let us not love in word or speech but in deed and in truth" (1John 3:17). God's love expressed in the Cross must be made visible in the world through the church. The evidence of eternal life is not the simple confession of Jesus Christ as Lord, but "faith working through love" (Gal. 5:6). Jesus said, "Not every one who says to me, 'Lord, Lord,' shall enter the kingdom of heaven, but he who does the will of my Father who is in heaven" (Matt. 7:21).

In light of the biblical teaching, there is no place for an "otherworldliness" that does not result in the Christian's commitment to his neighbor, rooted in the gospel. There is no room for "eschatological paralysis" nor for a "social strike." There is no place for statistics on "how many souls die without Christ every minute" if they do not take into account how many of those who die are dying of hunger. There is not place for evangelism that passes by the man on who was assaulted by thieves the road from Jerusalem to Jericho and sees in him only a soul that must be saved. "What does it profit, my brethren, if a man if a man says he has faith but has not works? Can his faith save him? If a brother or a sister is ill-clad and in lack of daily food, and one of you says to them, 'Go in peace, be warmed and filled,' without giving the things needed for the body, what does it profit? So faith by itself, if it has no works, is dead" (James 2:14-17).

Only in the context of a Soteriology that takes the world is it possible to speak of the oral proclamation of the If men are to call on the name of the Lord, they must believe in him —"and how are they to believe in him of whom they have never heard?" (Rom. 10:14). But the "word of reconciliation entrusted to the church is the prolongation of the act of reconciliation in

Jesus Christ. “For our sake he made him to be sin who knew no sin, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God” (2Cor. 5:21). It was thus—from within the situation of sinners, in an identification with them that he carried to its final consequences—that God in Christ reconciled the world to himself once and for all. This was the vertical movement of the gospel, the movement that in the Cross reached its darkest point. This is the heart of the gospel. But it is also the standard for evangelism. If God worked out reconciliation from within the human situation, the only fitting evangelism is that in which the Word becomes flesh in the world and the evangelist becomes “the slave of all” in order to win them to Christ (1 Cor. 9:19-23). The first condition for genuine evangelism is the crucifixion of the evangelist. Without it the gospel becomes empty talk and evangelism becomes proselytism.

The church is not an otherworldly religious club that organizes forays into the world in order to gain followers through persuasive techniques. It is the sign of the Kingdom of God, it lives and proclaims the gospel here and now, among men, and waits for the consummation of God’s plan to place all things under the rule of Christ. It has been free from the world, but it is in the world, it has been sent by Christ into the world just as Christ was sent by the Father (John 17: 11-18). In other words it has been given a mission oriented toward the building of a new humanity in which Gods plan for man is accomplished, a mission that can be performed only through sacrifice. Its highest ambition cannot and should not be to achieve the success that leads to triumphalism but rather faithfulness to its Lord, which leads it to confess that We are unworthy servants, we have only done what was our duty” (Luke 17:10). The confession can be made only by those who live by God’s grace and desire that all their works result in the glory of the one who died for all, “that those who live might live no longer for themselves but for him who for their sake died and was raised” (2 Cor. 5:15).

Remarks on “Evangelism and the World”

As I begin I would like to express my deep appreciation to those of you who have sent your questions and comments in response to my paper. It has been a great encouragement to me to see that many of you do in fact share my concern for an evangelization that is more faithful to the gospel and less bound to worldly ideologies. Only one of my readers has said that he doesn’t understand why my paper was ever written. Others may feel the same way, but they have kindly remained silent about it, and that has led me to believe that on the whole I have before me a rather sympathetic audience. I am therefore going to put all my cards on the table with the prayer that God lead us during these days to a clearer understanding of all that he expects of us as disciples of our Lord Jesus Christ in the twentieth century.

The task of answering all the questions that have been asked and amplifying all the points that have been said to need amplification is an impossible task. May I plead for your forbearance if it looks as if I'm not taking into account a question or comment you feel very strongly about. I've done my best l I themes that are not only closely related to my topic but also of the widest interest among those attending this meeting.

In the first section of my paper I take a look at the use of the use of the term *cosmos* (world) in the New Testament. My purpose is to show that according to the Scriptures the gospel is addressed not to man as an isolated being called to respond to God with no reference to his life context but rather to man in relation to the world. The gospel always comes to man in relation to the world of creation, the world that was made through Jesus Christ and that is to be re-created through him. It comes to man within the present order of existence, immersed in the transient world of material possessions. It comes to man as a member of humanity —the world for which Christ died, but at the same time the world hostile to God and enslaved to the powers of darkness. The aim of evangelization is, therefore, to lead man not merely to a subjective experience of the future salvation of his soul but to a radical reorientation of his life, including his deliverance from slavery to the world and its powers and his integration into God's purpose of placing all things under the rule of Christ on the other. The gospel is not to man in a vacuum. It has to do with man's movement from the old humanity in Adam, which belongs to this age that is passing away, into the new humanity in Christ, which belongs to the age to come.

In the second section of my study I attempt to bring out the significance of evangelization in relation to separation from the world. Because Jesus has been made Lord and King over all things through his death and resurrection, here and now, in anticipation of the deliverance of the whole creation from its bondage to decay, those who believe in him are delivered from slavery to the world and its powers.

Salvation is not exclusively forgiveness of sins, it also involves deliverance from the dominion of darkness to a realm in which Jesus is recognized as *Kyrios* of all the universe—the Kingdom of God's beloved Son (Col. 1:13).

May I here say parenthetically that the whole question of repentance could well have been considered in this second section rather than in the section dealing with evangelization and involvement with the world. Repentance does often have a negative connotation —it is a 'turning away from" according to Scripture. I have preferred to deal with it in the following section, it is simply because I want to emphasize not the act of repentance as such but rather the positive ethical

implications of repentance for man's life in the world..

To resume, then, in the second section of my study I illustrate the problem of worldliness in evangelization by referring first to the confusion of the gospel with moralistic rules and practices. In reaction to this, one of my critics asks, "Why is legalism considered worldliness' The Bible is full of negative commands." Biblical negative injunctions taken in the context of salvation history are one thing. They are included in the law that the New Testament describes as "holy and just and good" (Rom. 7:12). But rules and practices derived from "the tradition of the elders—they are something else. I am not defending a new (antinomian) morality. What I am doing is pointing out the danger of reducing the Christian ethic to a set of rules and regulations that "have indeed an appearance of wisdom . but have no value in checking the indulgence of the flesh" (Col. 2:23).

That there is a place for the use of the law in the Christian life (which in theology is known as "the third use of the law") no Christian should deny. The problem comes when the Christian life is turned into outward conformity to prohibitions and taboos that have no relation to the gospel. This, according to Paul, is a return to "the weak and beggarly elemental spirits" — a slavery to the world. But then, "aren't some of the negatives necessary safeguards for unstable Christians?" I see the need to raise up fences for the protection of small children. What concerns me is that these fences are often turned into cement walls within which there grows an "evangelical subculture," isolated from the real issues of life in the world.

If we think that we are in fact fostering separation from the world by maintaining a legalistic approach, let us not forget that one may conform to regulations such as Do not smoke" and "Do not drink beer' and still remain in slavery to the collective egoism that conditions man's life in the world. Whenever we concentrate on "microethics" and slight the problems of 'macroethics," we place ourselves under the Lord's judgment "Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites; for you tithe mint and dill and cummin, and have neglected the weightier matters of the law, justice and mercy and faith; these you ought to have done without neglecting the others. You blind guides, straining at a gnat and swallowing a camels" (Matt. 2323-24).

As a second illustration of the way in which worldliness can affect evangelization, I would like briefly to discuss the question of the adaptation of the gospel to the "spirit of the times." I cite two examples of such an accommodation. "secular Christianity" and "culture Christianity." As was to be expected, no one in this Congress really seems to disagree with my basic conclusion that "secular Christianity" is "not a mere 'restatement' of the gospel but rather a capitulation to a distorted concept of reality that is part of modern

secularism." The situation is entirely different when it comes to the question of culture Christianity. One of my critics holds that my description of this type of Christianity is 'so patently a caricature as to create static that cannot but block {the transmission of] many insights which people attending the conference will need." Another suggests that "What America is sharing with the world today is a parody of Christianity, tied to a materialistic philosophy and a truncated theology," and that although I come close to saying that, I "have not gone far enough." Whether my description is an overstatement or an understatement is not for me to decide In view of the conflicting opinions, however, it does seem extremely important for this Congress to come to grips during these days with the theological and practical issues related to the problem of culture Christianity. I, for one, believe that it would be a great pity if by the end of our time together we have done little more than pat one another on the back and tell one another that we have the right theology, that the evangelical churches are on the right track, and that all we need now is the right strategy and the most efficient methods for the evangelization of the world.

Please allow me to underscore the fact that I have no intention of judging the motives of the propounders of North American culture Christianity. It is the Lord who judges when he comes he will disclose the purposes of the heart and "if anyone builds on the foundation with gold, silver, precious stones, wood, hay, straw—each man's work will become manifest for the day will disclose it" (I Cor. 3:12-13).

My duty before God this morning is rather to try to make, with as much objectivity and fairness as I can, a theological evaluation of a type of Christianity than having as its center the United States, has nonetheless spread widely throughout the world.

Granted, I could have chosen a variety of "culture Christianity" other than "the American Way of Life," as some of you have suggested.

I do not wish to imply that North American Christians are the only ones who may fall into the trap of confusing Scripture and culture. The fact, however, is that because of the role that the United States has had to play in world affairs as well as in the spread of the gospel, this particular form of Christianity, as no other today, has a powerful influence far beyond the borders of that nation. So, for those of you who wonder why I condemn the identification of Christianity with "the American Way of Life" but not with other national cultures this is my answer. Behind my condemnation of this variety of culture Christianity lies a principle that applies to all varieties of culture Christianity — namely, that the church must be delivered from anything and everything in its culture that would prevent it from being faithful to the Lord in the fulfillment of its mission within and beyond its own culture. The big

question that we Christians always have to ask ourselves with regard to our culture is which elements of it should be retained and utilized and which ones should go for the sake of the gospel

When the church lets itself be squeezed into the mold of the world, it loses the capacity to see arid, even more, to denounce the social evils in its own situation. Like the color blind person who is able to distinguish certain colors but not others, the worldly church recognizes the personal vices traditionally condemned within its ranks but is unable to see the evil features of its surrounding culture In my understanding, this is the only way one can explain, for example, how it is possible for North American culture Christianity to infuse racial and class segregation into its strategy for world evangelization The idea is that people like to be with those of their own race and class and that we must therefore plant segregated churches, which will undoubtedly grow faster We are told that race prejudice "can be understood and should be made an aid to Christianization ' No amount of exegetical maneuvering can ever bring this approach in line with the explicit teaching of the New Testament regarding the unity of men in the body of Christ 'Here there cannot be Greek and Jew, circumcised and uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave, free man but Christ is all, and in all" (Col. 3 Il). "There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free, there is neither male nor female for you are all one in Christ Jesus' (Gal 3:28),. How can a church that deliberately opts for segregation or the sake of numerical expansion speak to a divided world? By what authority can it preach man's reconciliation with God through the death of Christ while at the same time denying mans reconciliation with man through the same death, when both are equally important aspects of the gospel (Eph 2:1, 14-18). As Dr Samuel Moffett put it at the Berlin Congress, "When racial discrimination enters the churches, it is something more than a crime against humanity, it is an act of defiance against God himself."

It is perhaps in this context that I should say a word about the prophetic ministry today, as I have been asked to do For it is only in the measure in which the church itself is the in carnation of God's purpose to put all things under the Lordship of Christ that it can denounce the evils in society which are a denial of Gods original purpose for man There is an internal connection between the life of the church and its prophetic ministry, and between the prophetic ministry of the church and its evangelization The church is called here and now to be what God intends the whole of society to be In its prophetic ministry it lays open the evils that frustrate the purpose of God in society in Its evangelization it seeks to integrate men into that purpose of God the full realization to which is to take place in the Kingdom to come Consequently wherever the church fails as a prophet it also tails as an evangelist.

A church that is not faithful to the gospel in all its dimensions inevitably becomes an instrument of the status quo. The gospel is meant to place the totality of life under the universal Lordship of Jesus Christ, not to produce cultic sects it is an open break with the status quo of the world. Therefore, a gospel that leaves untouched our life in the world—in relationship to the world of men as well as in relationship to the world of creation—is not the Christian gospel, but culture Christianity, adjusted to the mood of the day.

This kind of gospel has no teeth. It is a gospel that the "free consumers" of religion will want to receive because it is cheap and it demands nothing of them. The gospel in the first century was, according to Canon Michael Green, "politically suspect, socially disruptive." The gospel of culture Christianity today is a message of conformism, a message that is easily tolerated even by those who do not accept it, because it doesn't disturb anybody. The racist can continue to be a racist, the exploiter can continue to be an exploiter. Christianity for them will be something that runs alongside life but will not cut through it.

A truncated gospel is utterly insufficient as a basis for churches that want to be able "to generate their own Calvins, Wesleys, Wilberforces and Martin Luther Kings." It can serve as the basis for nothing more than unfaithful churches, strong holds of racial and class discrimination, religious clubs with a message that has no relevance to practical life in the social, economic, and political spheres.

Now perhaps I'm in a position to explain my reservations about the emphasis on numbers in relation to the Christian mission. One of my readers has commented, "I hope the author is not saying that those who advocate church growth and who think that the number of converts is important necessarily fall into the category of those who opt for superficial conversion. Some of us believe that both quality and quantity are important." My answer is that the numerical expansion of the church is a legitimate concern for anyone who takes the Scriptures seriously. As I have stated in my paper, this concern as such should not be questioned. "God desires that all men be saved and come to the knowledge of the truth." John R. Mott's concern to bring the gospel "within the reach of every creature within this generation" is a biblical concern and should be a part of our Christian commitment.

Furthermore, there is nothing to insure that those who win fewer people for Christ will be able to show forth higher-quality Christians as a result of their work. The point, however, is that quality is at least as important as quantity, if not more, and that faithfulness to the gospel should therefore never be sacrificed for the sake of quantity. When the gospel is presented to make it easy for all men to become Christians, from the very outset the basis is laid for an unfaithful church. As the

seed, so the tree, and as the tree, so its fruit. It follows that the real question with regard to the growth of the church is not successful numerical expansion—a success patterned after worldly standards—but faithfulness to the gospel, which will surely lead us to pray and work for more people to become Christians. I am for quantity, but for quantity in the context of faithfulness to the gospel. I am for numbers, but for numbers of people who have heard a presentation of the gospel in which the issues of faith and unbelief have been made clear and the choice between grace and judgment has been a free choice.

In contrast to the "gospel of the sword," the gospel of the Cross leaves open the possibility for people to reject Christ because they find his claims too costly, the gospel of the Cross admits that there are cases in which it is better not to have certain people in the church, even though that means a smaller membership. Was that not Jesus' attitude in dealing with the rich young ruler (Mark 10:17-22) and with the multitudes at the peak of his popularity? (Luke 14:25-32) Furthermore, if a truncated gospel necessarily results in churches that are them selves a denial of the gospel, in speaking of the numerical expansion of the church it is not out of place to ask what kind of church it is that is being multiplied. It may be that such multiplication turns out to be a multiplication of apostasy Obviously then, the real question is not numerical growth per Se, but faithfulness to the gospel.

In my paper, I state that culture Christianity has not only turned the gospel into a cheap product but has also turned the strategy for the evangelization of the world into a problem of technology One of my critics describes my reservations with regard to this approach to world evangelization as "a Latin American hangup." This is an *ad hominem* argument Latin Americans have not made any particular contribution to the definition of the limitations of technology when it comes to man. In fact, it is to a Frenchman, Jacques Ellul, that I appeal when I refer to the 'technological mentality" that conditions North American culture Christianity — the mentality according to which efficiency is an absolute criterion on the basis of which one should seek, in all areas of human life, the systematization of methods and resources to obtain preestablished results. It is to this absolutization of efficiency at the expense of the integrity of the gospel that I object Technology has its place in evangelization it would be foolish for me to deny that. The problem comes when technology is made a substitute for Scripture on the assumption that what we need is a better strategy rather than a more biblical gospel and a more faithful church. The picture of the church that one derives from the New Testament is certainly not that of a powerful organization that has achieved success in its conquest of the world by the masterly use of human devices and techniques. It is rather the picture of a community experiencing a new (supernatural) reality—the Kingdom of

God—to which "the Lord called day by day those who were being saved." As Michael Green has put it "In the early church the maximum impact was made by the changed lives and quality of community among the Christians." Changed lives and quality of community—that is to say, faithfulness to the gospel in practical life—do not come through technology, but through the Word and the Spirit of God Technology will never make up for our failure to let the gospel mold our lives!

Furthermore, if the strategy for world evangelization is tied to technology, then obviously the ones who have the final word on the strategy that the church is to follow in the future will be those who have the technical know-how as well as the resources to make the necessary investigations. The church in the Third World has nothing to say on the matter. Isn't this again a way to identify the gospel with worldly power, a way to perpetuate the domination/dependence patterns that have on the whole characterized missionary work for the last hundred years" What becomes of the universal character and the unity of the church of Christ But perhaps these things don't matter after all — perhaps the real problem is to produce the greatest number of Christians at the least possible cost in the shortest possible time!

If I have dealt mainly with North American culture Christianity, it is not because I am unaware of the fact that in other situations Christians may fall into the trap of accommodating the gospel to their own culture It is rather because of the broad influence of this variety of culture Christianity in evangelical circles around the world But I have no difficulty in accepting the fact that, as someone has put it, "There is a parallel danger in developing countries where national goals and leaders are idolized by mass cult," or that, as someone else has expressed it, "It is questionable whether we can accept in the Christian context some of the cultural aspects of other nations." There is, then, a place for the question of how we non-Americans can avoid creating our own version of culture Christianity. I will, however, attempt to kill two birds with one stone by taking up that question in connection with a similar question raised by an American who acknowledges the problem of culture Christianity in his own situation "How can I overcome culture Christianity, since I cannot get out of my own culture?"

In the first place, let us recognize the conditioning that the world and "the things that are in the world" exercise over us, even in relation to our service to God. All too often we are ready to condemn the distortions that others have openly al lowed to come into their theology through the front door, but we remain blind to the distortions that have come into our evangelization through the back door. The orthodoxy of our creed is no guarantee of our own faithfulness to the gospel in either our life or our service. The key word here is humility.

In the second place, let us be aware of the need to place our lives and activities continually under the judgment of the Word of God We cannot simply assume that we have the truth and that everything else, including our evangelization and our ethics, will just fall in line with that truth. The purpose of theology is not merely to reaffirm what previous generations have said but to bring the whole life and mission of the church into line with Gods revelation. All our assumptions and methods must therefore be examined in the light of Scripture The gospel itself, not success, is the criterion with which we must evaluate our work. The key phrase here is theological renewal.

In the third place, let us take seriously the unity of the body of Christ throughout the world. If the church is really one, then there is no place for the assumption that one section of the church has a monopoly on the interpretation of the gospel and the definition of the Christian mission. Those of us who live in the Third World cannot and should not be satisfied with the rote repetition of doctrinal formulas or the indiscriminate application of canned methods of evangelization imported from the West.

I am not advocating here a relativistic approach to theology. I am calling for the recognition of a problem and a change of attitude with regard to the making of theology and the planning of world evangelization. The problem is that one version of culture Christianity based on an inadequate theological foundation and conditioned by 'fierce pragmatism—the kind of pragmatism that in the political sphere has produced Watergate — is being regarded by some as the official evangelical position and the measure of orthodoxy around the world. The change of attitude being called for involves the renunciation of ethnocentrism and the promotion of theological cross-fertilization among different cultures. Under the Spirit of God, each culture has something to contribute in connection with the understanding of the gospel and its implications for the life and mission of the church. North American culture Christianity should not be allowed to deprive us of the possibility that we all —whatever our race, nationality, language, or culture—as equal members in the one body of Christ "attain the unity of the faith and of the knowledge of the Son of God, to mature manhood, to the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ" (Eph. 4: 13). The key word here is cross-fertilization.

I believe with all my heart that if with a humble spirit, recognizing our need of deliverance from the world, we come to the Word of God and are willing to learn from one another, the Spirit of God will work in us that we may be not merely a reflection of society with its materialism but "the salt of the earth" and "the light of the world."

The third section of my paper deals with evangelization of and involvement with the world. Here I first propose that repentance,

conceived as a reorientation of one's whole personality, throws into relief the social dimension of the gospel, for it involves a turning from sin to God not only in the individual subjective consciousness but in the world. Without ethics, I say, there is no repentance. Am I slighting the personal aspect of evangelization, as I have been accused of doing I don't think I am. "What I am doing is recognizing that man is a social being and that there is no possibility for him to be converted to Christ and to grow as a Christian except as a social being. Man never turns to God as a sinner in the abstract, he always turns to God in a specific social situation.

One objection that has been made regarding my emphasis on repentance is that the call to repentance is not an essential aspect of the gospel. Jesus' summons to repent "for the kingdom of heaven is at hand," I am told, "is addressed to the Jews," and we should not confuse Jesus' approach to the Jews with what would apply in the age of grace. "The Jews rejected Jesus' proposals, and he then offered, through his apostles and the Holy Spirit, the salvation to all by grace." When we come to the preaching of the gospel in the Gentile world—so this argument goes—the emphasis should be on faith rather than on repentance.

"What we have before us is a very serious question indeed. The argument has to do with nothing less than the very content of the message we are to proclaim to the world. There is no use in assuming that we all agree on the gospel that has been entrusted to us and that all we need now is more efficient methods to communicate it. If we think so, we deceive our selves. The gospel of repentance is one thing; the gospel of cheap grace is something else. Time doesn't allow me to discuss the question in full. Let me limit myself to the following observations.

1. In the Great Commission as it appears in Luke 24: 47, Jesus himself defines the message that is disciples are to proclaim to the nations as "repentance and forgiveness of sins in his name." That the early heralds of the message faithfully followed his instructions is attested by the book of Acts Repentance was an integral part not only of Peter's and the other early apostles' preaching among the Jews (Acts 2:38,3:19,5:31) but also of Paul's preaching among the Gentiles (Acts 17. 30,20,21,26,18). To those who would point to Acts 16: 31 ("Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved, you and your household"), let me point Out that verse 31 is followed by verse 32: "And they spoke the word of the Lord to him and to all that were in the home." To those who call my attention to I Corinthians 15:1-5 as a passage that contains a full synthesis of Paul's message and yet makes no reference to repentance, let me point out that the passage doesn't make explicit reference to faith either, the emphasis is on the facts of the gospel, not on the appropriation of it.

2. It is true that the words repentance and repent are not commonly found in the Pauline Epistles (but see Rom. 2:4; 2 or. 7.9, and 2 Tim. 2:25). This must not lead us, however, to contrast Paul's emphasis on justification by faith with Jesus' call to repentance. Justification can no more be separated from regeneration than forgiveness can be separated from repentance. Along with all the other writers of the New Testament, Paul holds that the God who justifies and forgives is also the God who delivers from slavery to sin As Joachim Jeremias puts it, "God's acquittal is not only forensic, it is not 'as if,' not a mere word, but it is God's word that works and creates life. God's word is always an effective word. As an antedonation of God's final acquittal, justification is pardon in the fullest sense. It is the beginning of a new life, a new existence, a new creation through the gift of the Holy Spirit "Justification, therefore, cannot be separated from the fruits of justification, just as faith cannot be separated from works. We do a great disservice to Paul if we fail to see that the same moral transformation to which the Gospels and Acts point when they use the term repentance is assumed by his teaching on dying to sin and being raised to life (Rom. 6) and on the new creation in which the old has passed away and the new is come (1 Cor. 5: 17) and on the contrast between gratifying the desires of the flesh and walking by the Spirit (Gal. 5).

3. Faith without repentance is not saving faith but pre sumptuous believism. The aim of the gospel is to produce in us faith, but faith that works through love. Without the works of love there is no genuine faith. If it is true that we are not saved by works it is also true that the faith that saves is the faith that works. As Luther put it, 'Faith alone justifies, but faith is never alone "The indicative of the gospel and the imperative of Christian ethics may be distinguished but must never be separated.

It is hard to avoid the conclusion that the basis for the denial of repentance as an essential aspect of the gospel is not the result of a careful study of Scripture but another expression of the attempt to accommodate the gospel to the world for the sake of numbers, a presumption that the message must be reduced to a minimum in order to make it possible for all men to want to become Christian. As a matter of fact, easy salvation (what Bonhoeffer calls "cheap grace') is part and parcel of the variety of culture Christianity to which I referred before My emphasis on repentance naturally raises the question of whether repentance, as I define it, does not ask too much of a new convert May I ask in response how much is too much' The most that man can give either to the living God or to the false gods of this world is his own life. But is that not precisely what God demands of man' Granted that following conversion there is a process of growth in which one comes to an increasing understanding of the implications of his commitment to Christ. The point, however, is that a conversion without repentance— that is to say, a

spurious conversion—can only lead to a Christian life without repentance — that is to say, a spurious Christian life Birth and growth form an organic unity, the only faith that will grow in obedience is the faith. that is born in obedience to God's command to repent Becoming a Christian is not a religious change, in which one becomes the adherent of a cult, but a reorientation of the whole man in relation to God, to men, and to creation. It is not the mere addition of new patterns imposed on the old—such as church attendance, Bible reading, and prayer—but a restructuring of one's whole personality, a reorientation of one's whole life in the world. If a person doesn't see that this is what he is in for with Christ, he is not in. The task of the evangelist in communicating the gospel is not to make it easier, so that people will respond positively, but to make it clear Neither Jesus nor his apostles ever reduced the demands of the gospel in order to make converts, God's kind ness, which is meant to lead to repentance, provides the only solid basis for discipleship. Cheap grace simply will not suffice. He who accommodates the gospel to the mood of the day in order to make it more palatable does so because he has for gotten the nature of Christian salvation, it is not man's work but God's. "With men it is impossible, but not with God, for all things are possible with God" (Mark 10:27).

The future of the church does not depend on our ability to persuade people to give intellectual assent to a truncated gospel but on our faithfulness to the full gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ and God's faithfulness to his Word. "Half gospels have no dignity and no future," said P. T. Forsyth "Like the famous mule, they have neither pride of ancestry nor hope of posterity.

Under the heading "evangelism and other-worldliness" I speak of two extreme positions with regard to the present world. The one is that which conceives of salvation as something that fits within the limits of the present age in terms of social, economic, and political liberation. The personal dimensions of salvation are eliminated or minimized. The individual is lost in society. There is little or no place for forgiveness from guilt and sin or for the resurrection of the body and immortality. This world is all that there is, and the fundamental mission of the church must therefore be conceived in terms of the transformation of this world through politics. At the other end of the scale is the view according to which salvation is reduced to the future salvation of the soul and the present world is nothing more than a preparatory stage for life in the hereafter. The social dimensions of salvation are completely (or almost completely) disregarded, and the church becomes a redeemed ghetto charged with the mission of rescuing souls from the present evil world. Didn't Jesus say, "My kingdom is not of this world"? Why should the church be concerned for the poor and the needy? Didn't he say, 'The poor you always have with you"? The only responsibility that the

church has toward the world, then, is the preaching of the gospel and the planting of churches. "There are many goods the church may do of course, but they do not belong to its essential mission."

I maintain that both of these views are based on incomplete gospels and that the greatest need of the church today is the recovery of the full gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ—the whole gospel for the whole man for the whole world.

On the one hand, the gospel cannot be reduced to social, economic, and political categories, nor the church to an agency for human improvement. Even less can the gospel be confused with a political ideology or the church with a political party. As Christians, we are called to witness to the transcendental, other-worldly Christ, through whose work we have received forgiveness of sins and reconciliation to God. We believe in man's need of a new birth through a personal encounter with God in Jesus Christ, by the action of the Holy Spirit, through the proclamation of the Word of God. And we maintain that nothing can take the place of spiritual regeneration in the making of new men. This is biblical Soteriology, and we are fully committed to it. We cannot accept the equation of salvation with the satisfaction of bodily needs, social amelioration, or political liberation.

On the other hand, there is no biblical warrant to view the church as an other-worldly community dedicated to the salvation of souls or to limit its mission to the preaching of man's reconciliation to God through Jesus Christ. As Elton Trueblood has put it, "A genuine gospel will always be concerned with human justice rather than with the mere cultivation of a warm inner glow." The responsibility of defining that relation between the gospel and the concern for human justice falls within the province of another paper—the one by my colleague Samuel Escobar.* I will limit myself to answering a few key questions out of the many that have been sent to me in response to my Own paper;

1. "How involved should we be in justice and economics?"

The fact is that, whether we like it or not, we already are involved. Politics and economics are unavoidable; they are a part of the reality that surrounds us while we are in the world The real question therefore, is, 'Since we are in fact involved, how can we make sure that our involvement is faithful to the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ?" Even though we may try to avoid taking any notice of politics and economics, they always take notice of us.

2. "Is the change of the structure of society a part of the evangelistic mandate?

The same question in essence, is asked in other words: "Are you not confusing the two kingdoms?" Here I can only reiterate that "the imperative of the evangelical ethic forms an indivisible whole with the

indicative of the gospel." Another way to put it would be to say that the two tables of the law belong together, or that concern for mans reconciliation with God cannot be separated from concern for social justice, or that the evangelistic mandate has to be fulfilled in the Context of obedience to the cultural mandate, or that the Kingdom of God manifests itself in the midst of the kingdoms of men, or simply that the mission of the church cannot be separated from its life. I refuse, therefore, to drive a wedge between a primary task—namely, the proclamation of the gospel—and a secondary (at best) or even optional (at worst) task of the church. In order to be obedient to its Lord, the church should never do anything that is not essential; therefore, nothing that the church does in obedience to its Lord is unessential. Why? Because love for God is inseparable from love for our neighbors; because faith without works is dead; because hope includes the restoration of all things to the Kingdom of God. I am not confusing the two kingdoms; I do not expect the ultimate salvation of man or society through good works or political action. I am merely asking that we take seriously the relevance of the gospel to the totality of man's life in the world The only possible alternative is to say that God is interested in our calling him "Lord, Lord" but not in our obedience to his will in relation to such crucial issues as social injustice and oppression, famine, war, racism, illiteracy, and the like

3. "Is it legitimate to say that Jesus was a political king? Are you not defining politics in your own terms?"

When I say that in describing Jesus as the Christ we are in fact describing him in political terms, I do not mean that he involved himself in what we today consider political action in a narrow sense, but rather that the title Messiah (king) is a political description. He did not come to create a religion but to accomplish God's purpose of placing all things under his government. Those who acknowledge him as Lord are not only reconciled to God but also given in him a model for human life, life in the polis. Here and now in this world, his disciples are called to bring their personal and corporate life into line with the will of God expressed in the ethics of the Kingdom, the central principle of which is love.

4. "In emphasizing the ethical, how do we avoid moralism and legalism in our teaching?"

By teaching the true nature of Christian morality is not outward subjection to rules and norms but heartfelt obedience in response to God, that the essence of Christian morality is gratitude The way to avoid the danger of falling into moralism and legalism is not to eliminate the ethical demands of the gospel but to see that obedience is an essential aspect of faith's response to the gospel and is always obedience by the power of God, who works in us through the Spirit.

5. "What can the church do, when the problems are so staggering?"

The church has not been called to solve all the pr to be faithful to God with what it has The greatest contribution that the church can make to the world is to be all that it is supposed to be Among other things, it should be the following:

First, it should be a community of *reconciliation*. In the midst of a fragmented world here is a community in which all barriers that divide disappear in which men learn to welcome one another as Christ has welcomed them, for the glory of God. Second, it should be a community of *personal authenticity*. In the midst of a world in which each man, has to fit into the mold imposed on him by his society, here is a community in which everyone is accepted as he is and encouraged to develop fully as individuals made in the image of God. Third, it should be a community of *serving and giving.* In the midst of a world in which man lives to be served and to receive, here is a community in which man lives to serve and to give.

This brings me to a conclusion. Our greatest need is for a more biblical gospel and a more faithful church. We may go away from this Congress with a nice set of papers and statements that will be filed away and forgotten, and with the memories of a big, impressive world meeting. Or we may go away with the conviction that we have magic formulas for the con version of people. My own hope and prayer is that we go away with a repentant attitude with regard to our enslavement to the world and our arrogant triumphalism, with a sense of our inability to break away from our bonds and yet also with a great confidence in God, the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who "by the power at work within us is able to do far more abundantly than all we ask or think. To him be glory in the church and in Christ Jesus, to all generations for ever and ever. Amen."

*Ed. Note: The reference is to "Evangelism and Man's Search for Freedom, Justice, and Fulfillment," by Samuel Escobar This paper also appears in *Let the Earth Hear His Voice*, pp. 307-18.

Padilla, René *Mission Between the Times*. Grand Rapids: Wm. B. Eerdmans, 1985.

Chapter 3

A Christian Response to Globalization

In my edition of the *Oxford Dictionary*, the term *globalization* does not appear. One can hardly be surprised that there are many people who would find it exceedingly difficult to come up with a definition. That being the case, it may help us to start by pointing to the kind of issue to which the term refers.

In Yalálag, a small village on the mountains of the State of Oaxaca, Mexico, my wife and I heard a group of small farmers tell us why so many young people from the various surrounding peasant communities are leaving their lands: "We cannot make a living by raising corn any longer," they said. "The corn that we produce here is much more expensive than the corn which is imported from the United States, which is subsidized by the U.S. government. Mexico lives on corn, but now most of the corn that our country consumes is imported, and we have been put out of business because we cannot compete with subsidized corn. As a result, many of our young people are migrating to the United States and sooner or later we have to sell our lands."[1]

In North Carolina we heard a similar story, also related to free trade--one of the main aspects of the phenomenon of globalization. In this case the people affected were a family who owned a textile factory. But not only they, since that factory had been used for many

years to empower poor people by providing on-the-job training which would enable them to eventually get better jobs. The death blow for that factory came with the importation of cheaper textiles from Japan.

Another aspect of globalization is illustrated by the family situation described some time ago by Ignacia Chávez de Cabrera, a poor woman who was living with her five children in a Latin American slum. They had a television and a stereo set. "Neither works," she complained, Abut we are still having to pay for them. It was my husband's idea. He was talked into it by the shopkeeper. Now 100 pesos a week go on those things and I do not have enough money for milk."[2]

Tens of thousands of similar stories could be told, showing the effects of globalization on people all over the world. On the basis of the three cases referred to, however, it should by now be clear the type of globalization that we are here talking about. We are not concerned in this

essay with globalization simply as the process through which multiple aspects of the natural, cultural, social, economic, and political reality that conform the *milieu* of human life have become interconnected in such a way that what happens or is done in one place is known by people in other places around the globe. Viewed from this perspective, globalization is experienced more than anything else in terms of a sort of planetary consciousness--the sense that a growing number of people all over the world seem to have of belonging to one world, as portrayed by the media. Perhaps a more appropriate term for it would be *internationalization.* That topic would deserve serious study, but that is not the subject of this essay. Nor are we here concerned with the anti-globalization movement, clearly portrayed by the massive protests that took place in Seattle during a summit meeting of the World Trade Organization (WTO), in December 1999. Hundreds of thousands of protesters from all over the world compelled the WTO to interrupt the meeting, despite the efforts of heavily armored police to repress the demonstration. We do not intend to deal here with today's global battle against globalization. Our focus here is, rather, on *capitalist globalization* promoted by business corporations and increasingly affecting people, especially the poor, everywhere, oftentimes in a negative way.

I. THE GLOBAL CAPITALIST SYSTEM

THE ARGENTINE CASE[3]

The way in which the global capitalist system often affects whole countries is exemplified by my adopted country—Argentina--where I have lived since 1967. Towards the year 1928, on the verge of a worldwide economic depression, the Argentine economy was in the twelfth place in the world, higher than that of Japan, Sweden, Austria, Italy and Spain. After the dramatic economic landslide in 2001, the number of people who could not satisfy their most basic needs increased at an average rate of 25,000 per day.[4] With more than half of its population living under the poverty line, Argentina became one more illustration of the pathetic appalling situation that is affecting the whole of Latin America, where hunger and marginalization affect more than two hundred million people, a high percentage of whom are children. No full analysis of the causes of the catastrophic impoverishment of one of the wealthiest Latin American countries is here possible, but the following comments would be appropriate.

In the first place, the greatest share of the responsibility for the condition of the country lies with the governing classes, and these in turn are the expression of a society in which corruption is endemic on all levels. Tax evasion, the favoring of friends and relatives and the use of bribes and sinecures are evils that permeate all of society, from the lowest to the highest spheres of the economic and political system. This widespread corruption reveals a shameful absence of ethical

values and a continual pursuit of individual material well-being that completely ignores the common good. The scandals involving ENRON, Xerox, MCI WorldCom, Arthur Anderson and others in the United States, however, show that corruption is a plague of immense proportions which is wreaking havoc in the world. I dare say that it is the principal cause of the growing gulf between rich and poor nations and between the rich and the poor within nations.

In the second place, the internal corruption is exacerbated by the corruption of the global economic system, due to the tragic complicity between transnational corporations and international financial organisms, on one hand, and the Argentine leaders, on the other.[5] The so-called "privatizations," instigated by the International Monetary Fund (IMF)[6] in the 1990s, were based on shady business deals that gave control of public services to transnational corporations and fattened the bank accounts of unscrupulous politicians. Generally speaking, however, they were of little or no benefit to the country.

In the third place, in view of the so-called *foreign debt*, the Argentine Government functions as a tax collector that tries to cover the national budget and at the same time to pay the imperial tribute. This budget, which is increasingly inadequate in terms of social benefits such as education, health care and retirement funds, assigns a high percentage to the payment of the interests[7] and has become a colossal transference of capital to the centers of world economic (and political and military) power. It has been proved that this debt, as well as immoral and unjust, is illegitimate because it was acquired by a military dictatorship--therefore a regime not elected democratically--and became an unbearable burden beginning in 1976, when private debts were imposed on the country through fraudulent transactions, with the acquiescence of the IMF.[8]

In the fourth place, Argentina has no control over transnational investments. Like most countries in the Two-thirds World, it is subject to the fluctuations of a market controlled by global economic structures which, through the flow of speculative capital, is leading to an economic accumulation of unprecedented proportions, with the subsequent growing gap between the rich and the poor on a global scale. There is plenty of evidence to show that the collapse of the Argentine economy which culminated in 2001 was at least in part connected with big-scale financial transactions made by transnational banks and corporations.

Other factors could be added to explain the economic and political crisis that threw millions of people, including many from the middle class, into poverty. Be that as it may, the fact remains that for the last few decades, and especially under the administration of President Carlos Saúl Menem and his successor De la Rua, this wealthy country was one of the most

faithful pupils of the IMF with regard to the application of its neo-liberal formulas for economic development.

TRANSNATIONAL PRACTICES AND ASSUMPTIONS

With the Argentine case in mind, we have a better basis to understand the meaning of capitalist globalization--a phenomenon that for many people represents a curse while for many others suggests a blessing, depending on its impact on men and women, young and old, living under different circumstances. This ambiguity, however, is dispelled when it is recognized that the dominant form of globalization at the beginning of the twenty-first century is the globalization of so-called neo-liberal capitalism. According to Leslie Sklair (2002:8), capitalist globalization, which emerged in the second half of the twentieth century, is "a particular way of organizing social life across existing state borders" and includes three inter-related transnational elements or (as he calls them) "practices": 1) the *transnational corporation,* "the major locus of transnational economic practices"; 2) the *transnational capitalist class*, "the major locus of transnational political practices", and 3) the *transnational culture-ideology of consumerism,* "the major locus of transnational culture-ideology practices." The primary moving force of today's economic global system is the transnational capitalist class-- made up of globalizing bureaucrats, politicians, and professionals--, that, according to Sklair (9), "derives its material base from the transnational corporations... and the value system of the culture-ideology of consumerism" and engages in "practices that cross [national] borders but do not originate with state actors, agencies, or institutions." All the evidence seems to point to the conclusion that "Global capitalism, driven by the TNCs [transnational corporations], organized politically through the transnational political class, and fueled by the culture-ideology of consumerism, is the most potent force for change in the world today"(47). The threat to democracy that this form of globalization represents has been eloquently brought out by George Soros, himself a successful capitalist, who writes:

Although I have made a fortune in the financial markets, I now fear that the untrammeled intensification of laissez-faire capitalism and the spread of market values into all areas of life is endangering our open and democratic society. The main enemy of the open society, I believe, is no longer the communist but the capitalist threat (1997:45).[9]

Since that indictment against capitalism was written, the global capitalist system has shown to be the greatest threat not only to democracy but also to the environment and to the very survival of humankind and especially of the poor around the globe.

In view of the predominant role of capitalism in this new era, a correct

understanding of what is going on in the world in general and in the nation-states in particular, which affects the poor, requires an analysis of the basic assumptions of the global capitalist system. No full discussion of this subject is here possible, but the assumptions can easily be recognized in the arguments employed by the advocates of global capitalism in defense of their position.

The most common economic assumption is that the integration of the local economies into the global capitalist system is the door that leads to economic progress--it benefits the industrialized as well as the "developing countries", the consumers as well as the producers, and it fosters competition by spreading technological knowledge, thus raising the level of productivity and profit-maximization everywhere. Such integration involves "deregulation", that is, the removal of barriers to the free flow of trade and capital investment, which will in turn set limits to the role of the government and reduce the possibility of corruption, stagnation, and bureaucracy--the evils that have hindered the growth of "developing economies". This orthodox recipe for economic growth through the free market-- "the invisible hand"--is spelled out in the so-called Washington Consensus, promoted by the United States, and enforced by international financial institutions such as the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund, and the World Trade Organization. It is supposed to provide the solution to world-wide poverty--if faithfully applied, even the poor countries will eventually become a part of the "First World" and their people will be able to experience the joys of living in the consumer society.

Goudzwaard and de Santa Ana (2003) have summarized the basic characteristics of this approach in three principles: 1) The Galileo-Descartes principle of *the primacy of the mathematical method*, which implies the possibility to reduce *physis* (nature) to a series of calculated entities and is directly linked with the operational or instrumental side of modernity. 2) The Hobbes-Rousseau principle of *social-constructive rationality*, which regards natural law as the basis for a logical (re)construction of human society. 3) The Locke-Spinoza principles of *individual freedom and equality*, which started from the recognition of individual rights--including private property--, but were also related to a positive evaluation of *self-interes*t. Eventually modernity and individual freedom came to be regarded as two sides of the same coin and found their way into the United States Declaration of Independence, into the new French Constitution, and into the structuring of economic life, for which Adam Smith laid the scientific basis. A further step was taken later on by Jeremy Bentham, the first thinker who used a mathematical method to check all types of social reconstruction with the motto, "the maximum happiness for the greatest number", thus relating the ordering of

society to the fulfillment of human wishes as the ultimate goal.

These Enlightenment principles became the basic assumptions of the ideology of modernity, which have permeated the Western spirit throughout the last three centuries. It was taken for granted that a rational approach would lead to socioeconomic reconstruction; that the mathematical-mechanical method was the way to attain economic efficiency; that autonomous will and individual self-determination were the main actors in economic development; and that utilitarian intervention in society is to be encouraged as long as it promotes the (material) well-being of all. On this basis, freedom and welfare became the political goals to be achieved not only in private but also in public life. Moreover, the relative rise in the standards of living and the achievements of science and technology led people to believe in the inevitability of progress--knowledge was increasing and, provided that the principles were faithfully applied, it would result in improvements in every area of human life. In time, this faith in progress through economy, science, and technology was firmly established and found its way into a modernization program, of which globalization may be regarded as the latest stage. The transnational corporations are the latest and most sophisticated embodiment of assumptions that took shape in Europe before the eighteenth century. The members of the transnational class are direct descendants of the Enlightenment. The transnational culture-ideology of consumerism is a revised version of modernity.

There is plenty of evidence, however, to demonstrate that the validity of the economic system built on the assumptions of the Enlightenment can no longer be taken for granted. Far from reducing poverty, the capitalist global system has become the main contributing factor in the extension and deepening of this major scourge. Indeed, the net result of the free-market formula is what Leslie Sklair has called a "class polarization"--the emergence of a transnational aristocracy of materially wealthy and politically powerful people over against increasing masses of poor and deprived people unable to satisfy their basic needs everywhere. The widening gap not only between rich and poor countries but also between the rich and the poor within countries, including those belonging to the First World,[10] clearly shows that the global capitalist system benefits the rich minority but locks the poor majority into poverty.

THE PRIMACY OF MONEY

In his prophetic book, *Capitalism and Progress: A Diagnosis of Western Society* (1979), the Dutch economist Bob Goudzwaard described Western society as a "system of progress" affected by three vulnerabilities:

1) The *ecological vulnerability,* made evident by the pollution of soil, water, and air, the extinction of numerous species of

plants and animals, and the decreasing availability of raw materials and energy as well as of cultivated land to feed the growing world population.

2) The *economic vulnerability*, demonstrated by inflation and "structural unemployment", under an economic system which has become "imbalanced and top heavy" (136), with an ethics that has been "placed in the service of economic expansion" (139).

3) The *human vulnerability,* shown by the way in which people are pressured "to accept *continual adjustment* to the external and obtrusive demands made on life-- "its style, tempo, and direction"(150) even with regard to sports, sexual life, and leisure time. People are forever in search of "excitement, sensation, and thrills" (149).

According to Goudzwaard, the society marked by these vulnerabilities is a "tunnel society"-- a society in which

Everything--people, institutions, norms, behaviour--contributes to the smooth advance toward the light at the end of the tunnel. But the end of the tunnel never appears to be within reach; the light shines forever *in the future.* Nevertheless, it keeps everything and everyone in the tunnel on the move (183)

On the move toward "continued economic, technological, and scientific development which we equate with social liberty and cultural advance"(185). This is a society, says Goudzwaard, in which faith in progress plays a fundamental role, but in which, at the same time, "Our progress has become our problem. The tunnel has become our trap" (*ibid.*). Since the publication of *Capitalism and Progress*, Goudzwaard has returned to the analysis of the problems of Western society, with particular emphasis on those related to economy and ecology. In *Beyond Poverty and Affluence: Toward an Economy of Care* (1995), co-authored with Harry de Lange, the former Professor of the Free University of Amsterdam shows that the economic problems which affect the industrialized nations have become *structural*. For Goudzwaard and de Lange, these are "new, bewildering, and seemingly inexplicable developments" unfolding in today's economy (2).

One does not have to be an economist to recognize the essential validity of this diagnosis of Western society. Already in the middle of the 1970s, Alvin Toffler saw the signs of what he called the "depression of the future", involving the breakdown of the industrial society and the birth of a new civilization (1975). Today's paradoxes show that the society which he predicted has arrived-- "a wholly new and dramatically different social order: a super-industrial civilization that will be technological, but no longer industrial" (3). Conventional economists are totally unable to explain, even less to cope with "today's schizophrenic economy, one that has lost touch with reality" (1). As Toffler

put it, “Nothing in the history of traditional industrial societies has prepared them (or us) for today’s high speed world of instant communication, Eurodollars, petrodollars, multinational corporations, and ganglia-like international banking consortia” (5).

No analysis of Western society, however, is complete if it does not take into account the role that material wealth plays in the free-market economy not only in the industrialized countries but all over the world today. Built on the assumption that economics is a positive, neutral, value-free science dealing with questions of production, consumption, income, and money in the market, the global economic system is almost totally oriented to the accumulation of wealth rather than to the satisfaction of basic human needs. According to Goudzwaard and de Lange, this system has as a result neglected at least four fronts: economic needs, nature and the environment, economic accountability, and labor. “Neoclassical economics was not designed to help these problems” (59). Wealth for the sake of wealth is the motto. The profit motive takes precedence over the subsistence motive; labor and raw materials are mere commodities. Under the rule of Mammon, the world is deeply affected by ecological, economic, and human vulnerabilities. It has become a “global casino” (Toffler 1975:1), one of whose fundamental characteristics is “the inability of national regulatory mechanisms to deal with transnational economic realities” (5).

This last statement by Toffler points to one of the main marks of the present-day global capitalist system: “transnational economic realities” which transcend “national regulatory mechanisms.” The institutional form of these realities are transnational corporations, banks, and international financial institutions whose economic practices transcend national boundaries. In the Latin American countries we are painfully aware that, whether we like it or not, we are part of a world economic system over which our nation-states and their governments have very little control or none at all. To speak of globalization today is basically to speak of “transnational economic realities” that decisively condition human life all over the world on both an individual and a community level. What has been globalized is, in fact, the so-called neo-liberal capitalist system with the industrialized countries at the center. The transnationalization of productive, trading, and monetary capital has transformed the planet into a world market oriented toward the accumulation of capital for the benefit of what Sklair has called a “transnational class”--Ca small powerful minority who are able to define national policies according to their economic interests, with total disregard for the basic needs of the population.[11] “With the transnational finance markets as the agents of the owners of money assets, the capitalist market economy has made significant progress towards its goal of running world society as an appendage to self-regulating markets” (Duchrow 1995:71).

If anything is clear today, it is that the solution that politicians, under the control of, or in connivance with, the wealthy minority, are trying to implement in the face of the paradoxes posed by the present global economic system is simply not working. At the root of the solution they propose is the assumption that economic problems are to be solved by letting the market of goods and services function freely, in conformity with the principle of competition. In practice, in a society characterized by a stark imbalance of power, the unavoidable result of competition is that the strong become stronger and the weak become weaker. In economic terms, the rich become richer and the poor become poorer. That this is, in fact, what is happening does not need to be demonstrated here. There is an overwhelming quantity of published evidence to show the devastating effects that market fundamentalism is having on the poor sectors of the population not only in Asia, Africa, and Latin America, but also in the wealthy countries; and not only on people, but also on the environment.

The most dramatic effect of the global market economy has been the emergence of a new division of society that throws into relief a new "class polarization"--the polarization between the rich and the poor, which becomes most visible in the Two-thirds World.[12] At the top of the social ladder are "the elect" who benefit from the system--the owners and managers of financial assets, the politically powerful, the market consumers *par excellance*.[13] At the bottom are "the excluded"--the increasing mass of people whose role with regard to the market is limited to that of (largely uninformed) spectators. They are excluded from the market, although not from society, because they are regarded as totally redundant in relation to the national and international financial transactions that take place at the top of the economic system. They are the first to suffer the consequences of drastic budgetary reductions in education, health, housing, social security, retirement programs, etc., imposed by the power holders. Unable to cover their basic needs, they pay the so-called *social cost* of macro-economic development. They are the victims that the system sets aside for the human sacrifice required by the "idolatry of the market"! (Assmann and Hinkelammert 1989).

A few years ago it was often said that, by selling their raw materials to the wealthy, the poor countries were mortgaging their future. Under the present capitalist global system their predicament has worsened to the point that there is no exaggeration in saying that no longer do the poor have a future to mortgage, for their future has been sold to the wealthy together with their present. Add to this the obvious ecological unsustainability of this perverse economic system, and one cannot avoid raising the question as to how it is possible that the myth should persist that laissez-faire capitalism will lead the whole world into an era of bonanza in which "the maximum happiness for the greatest number" will be

attained. The answer lies in what Sklair has aptly denominated the "transnational culture-ideology of consumerism", effectively spread all over the world through the mass media (2002:108-115). In fact, the mass media today play a predominant role in creating a global consciousness but also in facilitating the wide acceptance of the values of the consumer society, including the priority of money and material things in all areas of life. When public opinion is subjected to manipulation on the part of big economic interests, questions of public education, health, housing and ecological sustainability are indefinitely postponed for the sake of short-term profit-maximization and economic growth. To this end, the mass media make a qualitative difference with regard to the way in which power is today exercised by the powerful.

II. IN SEARCH OF A CHRISTIAN RESPONSE TO GLOBALIZATION

A sad comment on the neglect of the negative effects of capitalist globalization on the part of Christians is the almost total absence among us of a social and political ethic. No one would deny that there is a great distance between *understanding* the complex problems that beset the poor on a local, national and global scale and putting into practice that which ought to be done. Even so, the least one would expect of people who claim to believe in a God of love and justice is an effort to articulate, in light of Scripture, a vision of a better world--not the Kingdom of God on earth, here and now, but a more just society, more coherent with what God intends for humankind. On the basis of that vision, we will be in a better position to answer questions that are absolutely basic for a truly Christian lifestyle: What is the Christian response to capitalist globalization? How can Christians, as individuals and as communities, make a difference in a globalized world dominated by a transnational capitalist class that derives its power from the transnational corporations and the culture-ideology of consumerism?

I cannot even begin to suggest a detailed response to these questions in this essay. The most I can do is to attempt to mention some of the main challenges that these questions pose to those of us who confess Jesus Christ as our Lord and accept the authority of Scripture in all matters not only of faith but also of practice. Prior to the consideration of these challenges, however, we need to agree on the legitimacy of the questions. Sad to say, we cannot even take for granted that Christians in general will agree that the questions of involvement in issues of social and economic justice are relevant to the life and mission of the church in today's world!

FOUR DISABLING FACTORS

There are, in fact, at least four factors that oftentimes prevent Christians from dealing with these issues. One factor is the passive acceptance of economic

Darwinism. From this perspective, hard work results in individual success -- individual economic progress-- and poverty is the result of laziness. Does not the Bible say, "A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to rest, and poverty will come on you like a bandit and scarcity like an armed man" (Prov 6:10-11)? In answer to this position, it must be said that no one would deny the frequent connection between laziness and poverty and between hard work and wealth. But what about other reasons for poverty, such as natural disasters or exploitation, and other reasons for wealth, such as inheritances and oppression?

Another disabling factor is the privatization of faith. In a world that is split between the sacred and the secular, faith is restricted to the private life; it bears on questions of individual morality but is totally unrelated to worldly matters such as economics and politics. Accordingly, the task of the church is to preach the gospel for the salvation of souls; it should not be distracted with tasks that may be good but do not directly bear on the question of eternal life. Issues of social and economic justice should be left to the state. But what is the role of the state? Should it be reduced to insuring religious freedom, curtailing abortion or homosexuality, and promoting economic development through business corporations?

A third factor is a futuristic view of the Kingdom of God. In the future, it is said, God will establish his Kingdom of justice and peace. We need not be concerned about changing the world, which, according to Biblical teaching, is going to get worse before Jesus' return and will in the end be destroyed. Our present task is restricted to "making disciples", not to changing the world. Besides, did not Jesus say, "the poor you will always have with you"? But can the Kingdom be understood exclusively in terms of a future category? If Jesus was anointed by the Spirit of the Lord "to preach good news to the poor... to proclaim freedom to the prisoners and recovery of sight to the blind, to release the oppressed, to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor" (Lk 4:18-19), does his mission make any difference with regard to the way in which the church prolongs his mission in the present, in anticipation of the consummation of the Kingdom? Does the inauguration of the Kingdom in the person and work of Jesus Christ have any relevance for the way in which the church understands her mission?

Christians who reject the idea of involvement in issues of social and economic justice because of one or more of the three factors we have mentioned so far may appeal to Scripture in order to support their arguments. A much more difficult task, however, is to marshal Biblical evidence to provide a rationale in favor of what may be the strongest factor disabling many Christians, not only in the United States but all over the world, to express love for justice in practical ways, namely, a massive accommodation of the

church to the consumer society. As Sklair (2002:116) has put it,

Without consumerism, the rationale for continuous capitalist accumulation dissolves. It is the capacity to commercialize and commodify all ideas and the products in which they adhere, television programmes, advertisements, newsprint, books, tapes, Cds, videos, films, the Internet, and so on, that global capitalism strives to appropriate. Habermas... pointedly termed this "the colonization of the lifeworld."

THREE BASIC CHALLENGES

Only if we agree that we Christians ought to be involved in issues of socioeconomic justice, we will see the need for a Christian response to present-day capitalist globalization. For the sake of space, rather than trying to provide a full-fledged response, I would like to briefly outline what may be regarded as a minimum program for the articulation of the response to three challenges posed by globalization: the theological challenge, the missiological challenge, and the spiritual challenge.

The Theological Challenge

Western (at least Protestant) theology is all too often divorced from practical life. Its focus is on orthodoxy, but it frequently fails to give adequate attention to orthopraxis. In Dyrness' words (2003:15), "If medieval theologians were preoccupied with >being,' one might say Protestant theologians came to focus almost exclusively on >truth.'... Religiously speaking, one might say that *doing* something was in danger of being replaced by *thinking* about something." As a result, theology frequently fails to provide the church the necessary guidelines for action on behalf of socioeconomic justice in society.

As heirs of the Reformation of the sixteenth century, we all agree that salvation is by grace through faith: "it is the gift of God--not by works, so that no one can boast" (Eph 2:9). But we cannot stop at that. In Ephesians 2 Paul goes on to say that "we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do" (v. 10). If we believe that our God is a God of justice, and if justice is "to sort out what belongs to whom, and to return it to them" (Walter Brueggemann), what are the good works that God expects from us in the face of a world controlled to a large extent by a transnational class that, for the sake of profit, is increasingly institutionalizing injustice on a global scale?

One of the most urgent theological tasks today is a definition of the role of the State in light of Scripture. There is no basis to believe that our duty as Christians is to seek to install a State that will impose Christian morality. It is clear, however, that there is an urgent need for the State to intervene and give priority to supplying food, health care, education, social

security for pensioners and senior citizens and adequate care of the environment. It is totally unacceptable to leave the task of insuring that common people are able to meet their basic needs and the task of protecting the environment in the hands of opportunist politicians, selfish entrepreneurs or financial speculators. The State cannot privatize these sectors because the aim of private capital is immediate profit and not the well-being of all. The State which, either due to ineptitude or negligence, disregards the needs of its people is not fulfilling its most basic commitment and places itself under God´s judgement. In evangelical tradition the State is one of the orders of creation whose inescapable duty is to provide for all human beings adequate opportunity for a decent life and relationships based on justice.

The Missiological Challenge

For too long in evangelical circles we have identified the mission of the church with transcultural missions and have defined our task as that of saving souls and planting churches. I have no doubt that mission includes personal evangelism, and that evangelism involves a call to repentance and faith. Scripture, however, does not allow us to reduce the mission of the church to the oral proclamation of the Gospel.

The International Congress on World Evangelism, held in Lausanne, Switzerland, in 1974, was a milestone in the evangelical camp in terms of the acceptance of a new understanding of the comprehensive character of the mission of the church. Paragraph 5 of the *Lausanne Covenant* exemplifies this understanding in the following terms:

> We affirm that God is both the Creator and the Judge of all men. We therefore should share his concern for justice and reconciliation throughout human society and for the liberation of men from every kind of oppression. Because mankind is made in the image of God, every person, regardless of race, religion, color, culture, class, sex or age, has an intrinsic dignity because of which he should be respected and served, not exploited. Here too we express penitence both for our neglect and for having sometimes regarded evangelism and social concern as mutually exclusive. Although reconciliation with man is not reconciliation with God, nor is social action evangelism, nor is political liberation salvation, nevertheless we affirm that evangelism and socio-political involvement are both part of our Christian duty, for both are necessary expressions of our doctrines of God and man, our love for our neighbor and our obedience to Jesus Christ. The message of salvation implies also a message of judgment upon every form of alienation, oppression and discrimination, and we should not be afraid to denounce evil and injustice wherever they exit. When people receive Christ they are born again into his kingdom and must seek not only to exhibit but also to spread its righteousness in the midst of an unrighteous world. The salvation we claim should be transforming us in the totality of our personal and social responsibilities. Faith without works is dead.

Since this statement was drafted, the situation of the world has become much more complicated from the perspective of class polarization and the destruction of the ecosystem. Today it is all the more

necessary to recognize that the mission of the church includes the prophetic word and involvement in issues of justice and peace.

The need for a holistic approach to mission that gives proper attention to the personal as well as to the social dimension of the gospel and grants equal importance to being, doing, and saying the witness to Jesus Christ is present *everywhere*--in East and in the West, in the North and in the South. If there was a time when *mission* could be defined primarily in geographical terms, as a one-way movement from Christian countries to (mission fields" beyond, that time is past. Mission (in singular) begins with God and is at the very heart of the church; missions (in plural) are the multiple ways in which the church everywhere crosses a wide variety of frontiers in order to make the transforming power of the triune God visible in every area of human life. Every human need is a "mission field" and all believers are called to cooperate with God in his purpose to manifest in relation to it, by the power of the Spirit, the love and justice that were revealed in Jesus Christ. The benefits of the gospel cannot be separated from mission as the central task of the church. Consequently, for every person who confesses Jesus Christ as Lord and Savor active participation in God's mission to make life whole is both a privilege and a responsibility.

Undeniably, "the love of money is the root of all kinds of evil" and government policies in the "global village" today are controlled by a transnational class of decision makers dedicated to serving the god Mammon. If that is the case, it is of utmost importance that the church develop a missionary strategy that takes serious stock of the need for Christians in different walks of life to fully recognize that "a man´s [or nation´s] life does not consist in the abundance of his [or its] possessions" (Luke 12.15) and support an economy designed for people, not for profit. The call today is for a missiology that, over against the globalization of an unjust economic system built on selfish individualism, aims at the globalization of solidarity across national and ethnic borders.

The Spiritual Challenge

The result of our critical analysis of the globalization of neo-liberal capitalism may be the feeling that nothing can be done with regard to the problems that this form of globalization has created, especially the polarization between rich and poor and the destruction of the ecosystem. This feeling of helplessness, combined with the common assumption that "there is no alternative" to the capitalist system, may be the main reason why so many people, Christian and non-Christian, who recognize the negative impact of global capitalism on life on planet Earth abstain from actively participating in the struggle for socioeconomic and political transformation.

For Christians, however, resistance to the consumer society--a system built on false assumptions and distorted values--is not optional. The problems that global capitalism poses are not merely, nor even primarily, economic or technical, but moral and spiritual. Cynthia D. Moe-Lobeda is therefore right in claiming that "the call to >love thy neighbor as thyself' includes a call to subvert structures of exploitation and to forge faithful alternatives" (2002:xiv).

At the same time, however, we need to acknowledge that the struggle to which we are called cannot be faced on the basis of mere human strength, since "our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against rulers, against authorities, against the powers of this dark world and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms" (Eph 6:12). As I argued in a symposium on the *Lausanne Covenant* many years ago, "Behind the materialism which characterizes the consumer society lie the powers of destruction to which the New Testament refers" (1976:211). I synthesized the New Testament (especially Pauline) teaching on "this world" as "a system in which evil is organized in opposition to God" and concluded:

Both technology and capital can put themselves at the service of either good or evil. From their union, which recognizes no ethical principle, has emerged the society which worships economic prosperity and the consequent material well-being of *homo consumens.* The consumer society is the very social, political and economic situation in which the world dominated by the powers of destruction has taken form today: the blind faith in technology, the irreversible reverence for private property as an inalienable right, the cult of increased production through the irresponsible sacking of nature, the disproportionate enrichment of the multinational [transnational] corporations which further impoverishes the "disinherited of the earth," the fever of consumerism, ostentation, and fashion. This materialism is the ideology which is destroying the human race (213).

If this interpretation of the nature of the struggle in which we are engaged is correct, as I believe it is, the first requirement for the fulfillment of our call is to heed Paul's exhortation "to be strong in the Lord and in his mighty power" and "to put on the full armor of God" consisting of the belt of truth, the breastplate of justice, the gospel of peace, the shield of faith, the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, and prayer in the Spirit (Eph 6:10-18). In other words, the starting point for a Christian response to the dehumanizing form of globalization that we have briefly analyzed is to acknowledge with utter seriousness that our life and mission are rooted in the Gospel--the good news concerning the life and work of the our Lord Jesus Christ--and must be carried out with "prayer in the Spirit." .

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ENDNOTES

Chapter 1
The Church, the Word and the Mission at the Beginning of the 21st Century.

[1] This is by no means to deny the importance of the spiritual dimension of salvation. However, it is one thing to make this affirmation; it is something quite different to reduce the gospel to an otherworldly message, which loses sight of the fact that eternal life is not simply life after death "not just an eschatological idea" but a whole different lifestyle, characterized here and now by the love of God and the love of one's neighbor.

[2] E.g., in Ac 5:31, 13:33; Eph 5:23; Php 3:20; 2Ti 1:10; Tit 1:4, 2:13, 3:6; 2Pe 1:11, 2:20, 3:2, 18; 1Jn 4:14. It must be remembered, however, that the name Jesus means "savior".

[3] See, e.g., Lk 7:6, 9:59, passages in which *kyrios* is no more than a polite address, like "Mr. Jones". There are also passages where *kyrios* carries the idea of "master" or a "boss" (cf. Mt 18:25, 27). These meanings, however, stand in contrast to many other passages, especially in Paul=s letters and the last two chapters of John=s Gospel, in which the term is used with Christological connotations, probably associated with a Christian reading of Psalm 110:1, where the Messiah is referred to as "Lord". Most probably calling Jesus "Lord" acquired the idea of deity only after his resurrection and exaltation. David J. Bosch, however, notes that in Matthew the only ones who use the word "Lord" in reference to Jesus are the disciples or those who came to him looking for help, whereas his adversaries always call him "Rabbi" ("Teacher"), never "Lord". The designation of Jesus as "Lord" by his
disciples in this gospel is so consistent that, where his sources use ("Teacher", Matthew changes it to "Lord". On this basis Bosch concludes that "it can hardly be doubted that Matthew understood it (i.e. the title "Lord") primarily as a divine title (*Transforming Mission: Paradigm Shifts in Theology of Mission, Maryknoll, N.Y., Orbis, 1991, pp.75-76).*
[tr] (translators note) Bible quotations are from the New Revised Standard Version.

[4] Cf. Oscar Cullmann, *The Christology of the New Testament,* London: SCM, 2nd ed., 1963, Ch. 7.

[5] See however Ro 4:17; 1Co 6:9,10; 15:24, 50; Gal 5:21; Col 1:13; 4:11; 2Th 1:5; 2 Ti 4:1.

[6] Cullmann, *ibid*., p. 215.

[7] The verb "make disciples" (*mathetuein*) occurs only four times in the New Testament: three times in Matthew (13:52, 27:57, and 28:19) and once in Acts (14:21). Only in the "Great Commission" in Matthew does the verb appear in the imperative and in this passage it defines the main action, the content of the mission. The participles "baptizing" and "teaching", on the other hand, outline *how* the action of making disciples is to be carried out.
The noun "disciple" (*mathetes)* is common in the Gospels and Acts, but it does not appear in the rest of the New Testament. It appears 73 times in Matthew, 46 in Mark and 37 in Luke. In the synoptic Gospels, it is the word used to refer to the followers of Jesus, although in Mark and Luke it is restricted to the twelve, while in Matthew it is used more widely: it includes the twelve, of course, but not exclusively.

[8] For an excellent exposition of this way of understanding the Church in relation to the lordship of Christ see Darrell K. Guder, *Be My Witnesses: The Church=s Mission, Message, and Messengers* (Grand Rapids: Wm. B. Eerdmans Publishing Company, 1985). According to this author, "It is a tragic heresy to reduce the lordship of Christ to the religious and spiritual side of life, when he clearly said that he had been given all authority in heaven and on earth" (p. 177).

[9] José María Castillo, *El seguimiento de Jesús*, Salamanca: Sígueme, 1986, p. 13, tr.

[10] John H. Yoder *The Priestly Kingdom: Social Ethics as Gospel,* Notre Dame, Indiana: University of Notre Dame, 1984, p. 55.

[11] Many years before the emergence of liberation theology in Latin America, E. Stanley Jones, a Methodist missionary in India, interpreted Jesus' "keynote discourse" in the Nazareth synagogue (Lk 4:18-19) as the program, in general terms, of the Kingdom of God on earth. Cf. *Cristo y el communism* (abridged edition), El Paso:Mundo Hispano, 1974. The original work in English, *Christ=s Alternative to Communism,* was published originally in 1935. According to Jones, Christ "has given us a kingdom, which is no less than the New Order, the ultimate Order that opens the way to transcend the existing order and change it; and we have turned it into a sheepfold that we rush into, looking for refuge and hoping that Jesus will carry us up to heaven" (p. 83), tr.; only Spanish available to the author.

[12] John Perkins, *Beyond Charity: The Call to Christian Community Development*, Grand Rapids: Baker Books, 1993, p. 39.

[13] The other four accounts are in the four Gospels: Mt 28:18-20, Mk 16:15-18 (although the most ancient manuscripts do not include Mk 16:9-20), Lk 24:46-49 and Jn 20:22-23. For an excellent exegetical and contextual study of these passages see Mortimer Arias, *La Gran Comision,* Quito: CLAI, 2001.

[14] Emil Brunner, *The Misunderstanding of the Church, London:* Lutterworth Press, 1952, p. 12.

[15] Yoder, *op. cit*., p. 94.

[16] Leonardo Boff, *Ecclesiogénesis: Las comunidades de base reinventen la Iglesia*, *(Ecclesiogenesis: Base Communities Reinvent the Church)*, Santander: Sal Terrae, 1984, p.10. English translation published by Orbis Press.

[17] *Ibid*., p. 39.

[18] 1Pe 4:11 could be added to the passages noted, but this passage does not actually offer a list of gifts. It refers only to two general categories in which the others could be classified; those concerned with speaking and those concerned with serving.

[19] Guder, *op. cit*., p. 193.

[20] Cf. *op. cit*. For Brunner Athe *Ecclesia* as *koinonia Christou* and *koinonia pneumatos*, like the "body of Christ, is a pure communion of persons entirely without institutional character" (pp. 16,17), while the historical Church "is rather something which has arisen in the course of a long and complicated history, through a process of development, transformation and retrogression, out of the New Testament *Ecclesia"* (pp. 14, 15).

[21] *Ibid*., p. 117.

[22] *Ibid*., p. 118.

Chapter 2
Evangelism and the World

[1].See Matt. 24:21, John 19-10, 17:5, 24; Acts 17:24; Rom. 1:20; 1 Cor. 4:9; 8:4; Eph. 1:4; Phil. 2: 15; Heb. 4:3; 9:26.

[2] It is noteworthy that the New Testament never uses the term cosmos to the eschatological world of the Christian hope, for which other expressions are used.

[3] See Matt. 4:8; John 8:23; 12:25; 16:33; 18:30; 1 Cor. 7:31; 1 John 3:17; 1 Tim. 6:7

[4]. See Matt. 5:14, 13:38, 18:7; I Cor. 1:27-28, 3:22, 4:13, 2 Pet. 2:5, 3:6; Heb. 11:7, 38

[5] The texts in which cosmos with this connotation appears are numerous in Johannine and Pauline writings. The usage of the term with this meaning is peculiar to the New Testament.

[6] Vincent Taylor, Forgiveness and Reconciliation, A Study in New Testament Theology London: Macmillan, 1941), p. 273.

[7] This position is illustrated by Oscar Cullmann's affirmation that "the fundamental distinction . . . between all the members of the lordship of Christ and the members of the Church is that the former do not know that the latter do know it" (*The Christology of the New Testament*, trans. Shirley C. Guthrie and Charles A. M. Hall [1955; Philadelphia: Westminster Press, 1963], p. 231).

[8] Künneth, *The Theology of the Resurrection* trans James W. Leitch (1965, St. Louis: Concordia, 1966), pp 161 62

[9] The Cartesian dictum "I think, therefore I am" fails to take into account the fact that man is not merely a mind but a mind/body (a psychosomatic being) living and acting in the world, and that the "subjective" and "objective" aspects of reality are therefore inseparable in knowledge. Those burdened with this misperception tend to split reality into two levels: the upper level of the 'subjective" (feelings and religion) and the lower level of the objective" (facts and science)—and in fact this split is behind much thinking in the fields of science, philosophy, and theology.

[10] See Blaikie, Secular Christianity and the God Who Acts (Grand Rapids: William B. Eerdmans, 1970).

[11] David O. Moberg, *The Great Reversal Evangelism versus Social Concern* (Philadelphia: Lippincott, 1972), p. 42.

[12] See Ellul, *The Technological Society*, trans. John Wilkinson (1954, New York: Random House-Vintage, 1970).

[13] See Skinner, *Beyond Freedom and Dignity* (New York: Knopf, 1971).

[14] On this, see Gustavo Gutiérrez, Teologia de la liberacion (Lima Editorial Universitaria, 1973), p 132.

Chapter 3
A Christian Response to Globalization

[1]In a world in which more than a billion people live with less than $1 per day, in 2002 the Government of the United States allocated $180 billion to subsidize large agribusiness instead of small farming businesses in this country--20% of the farms received over 80% of the subsidies. These subsidies lead to the massive "dumping" of USA agricultural products on world markets, causing the bankruptcy of local farmers, who cannot compete with prices that are below their production costs. The complete elimination of this kind of subsidies must precede any plan for the integration of the economies of this hemisphere, such as the Free Trade Area of the Americas (FTAA)..

[2]This story was told by Alan Riding in "Malnutrition Taking a Bigger Toll Among Mexican Children," *New York Times,* March 6, 1978, A-2.

[3]For a more detailed study of the Argentine case, see my essay on the subject in *Economía humana y economía del Reino de Dios* (Buenos Aires: Ediciones Kairós, 2003).

[4]According to a recent UNICEF report, out of every ten children in Argentina seven are poor, which means that almost five million minors have no access to goods and services required to satisfy their basic needs. Out of these, 1,150,000 became poor between 2001 and 2003, at an average of 1,570 per day. This figure throws into relief an increase of 36.6 per cent in the number of children and teenagers in the last two years. On the other hand, the gap between the one fifth of the population with the lowest income and the one fifth with the highest income increased from 1 to 12 in 1970 to 1 to 40 in 2001 as an average. Cf. LA NACION, Buenos Aires, November 27, 2003.

[5] Carefully-researched evidence for this is provided by Andrés Oppenheimer in *Ojos vendados: Estados Unidos y el negocio de la corrupción en América Latina* (Buenos Aires: Editorial Sudamericana, 2001).

[6] On the poor performance record of the IMF not only in Argentina but also in other countries, such as Turkey and Indochina, see Joseph E. Stiglitz, *El malestar en la globalización* (Buenos Aires; Taurus, 2002). Only the Spanish translation was available to the author. In view of the negative effects of this performance in countries that are supposed to be helped by it in times of economic crisis, it is not surprising that the IMF is oftentimes viewed outside the United States as a branch of the U.S. Treasury Department.

[7] The interests on the debt, which amounted to over 3,500 million dollars per year during the 1990s, were 8,000 million dollars during 2001. This amazing increase of payments to multilateral credit organizations eroded the national budget and was one of the causes of the 2001 crisis and the resulting default. The figures show that the IMF makes a sizable economic profit from the countries in relation to which it acts as consultant in times of crisis. Between 1980 and December of 2000, the IMF made $15,400 million in Latin America: it handed over 71,300 million to Latin American countries and they returned 86,700 million.

8 The development of the Argentine foreign debt has been carefully traced by Martin Kanenguiser in *La maldita herencia* (Buenos Aires: Sudamericana, 2003). In 1976, the public debt was US$6,648 millions and the private one was US$3,091 millions. Five years later, the public debt had ascended to US$20,024 millions and the private one to US$15,000 millions, representing 390.4% of the exports. Ten years later the foreign debt had increased to US$61,334 millions.

[9]Soros expanded this thesis in *The Crisis of Global Capitalism: The Open Society Endangered* (1998). In line with Soros, Cynthia D. Moe-Lobeda, in *Healing a Broken World: Globalization and God*, chapter 2 (30-45), "Disabling Democracy: Subordinating Democratic Political Power to Economic Power," convincingly argues that "Corporate and finance-driven globalization disables moral agency by disabling democracy. More specifically, globalization subordinates democratic political power to unaccountable economic power. This corrosion of democracy undermines citizens' capacity to shape economic structures, policies, and lifestyles that will build social justice and establish regenerative Earth-human relations" (39).

[10] AThe *Washington Post* carried an article on March, 1998, saying that the richest 1% of the US population possesses more wealthy than the total wealth of 90% of the total population. The bottom 25% of US families witnessed a 9% decline in income between 1979 and 1995, with the richest 25% of families enjoying a 26% increase during the

period, according to a *USA Today* report in 1997. The income of the richest 5% of families was 5.7 times that of the bottom 20% of families in 1995. Official statistics released in 1997 show that the top 20% of US families shared 49% of the country's total income in 1996, with the income level for the bottom 20% falling by 1.8%. The current level of the top 20% of the population is nine times more than the figure for the bottom 20%, up significantly from the 3.5 times figure in 1979. In addition, some 75% of American workers earn less today than in 1979. 16% of the US population lived below the poverty line in 1974, with the figure rising to 19% in 1997" (Leslie Sklair 2002:53).

[11] According to Sklair, this "class" is transnational in at least five senses: "Its members tend to share global as well as local economic interests; they seek to exert economic control in the work place, political control in domestic and international politics, and culture-ideology control in everyday life; they tend to have global rather than local perspectives on a variety of issues; they tend to be people from many countries, more and more of whom begin to consider themselves citizens of the world as well as of their places of birth, and they tend to share similar lifestyles, particularly patterns of luxury consumption of goods and services" (2002:28-29).

[12] A clear illustration of this polarization is given by Amy Chua (2003:13-14), professor of law at Yale University, who writes: "My family is part of the Philippines' tiny but entrepreneurial, economically powerful Chinese minority. Just 1 percent of the population, Chinese Filipinos control as much as 60 percent of the private economy, including the country's four major airlines and almost all of its banks, hotels, shopping malls, and conglomerates. My own relatives in Manila, who run a plastics conglomerate, are only 'third-tier' Chinese tycoons. Still, they own swaths of prime real estate and several vacation homes. They also have safe-deposit boxes full of gold bars, each the size of a Snickers bar, but strangely heavy." Further on she adds: "Nearly two-thirds of the Philippines' 80 million ethnic Filipinos live on less than two dollars a day. Forty percent spend their entire lives in temporary shelters. Seventy percent of all rural Filipinos own no land. Almost a third have no access to sanitation" (14). To Amy Chua, markets, democracy, and ethnic hatred--the kind of ethnic hatred that led a chauffeur to kill this author's aunt, are "among the three most powerful forces operating in the world today" "After the fall of the Berlin wall, a common economic and political consensus emerged, not only in the West but to a considerable extent around the world. Markets and democracy, working hand in hand, would transform the world into a community of modernized, peace-loving nations.... The sobering lesson of the last twenty years, however, is that the global spread of free-market democracy--at least in its current, raw for-export form--has been a principal aggravating cause of ethnic violence throughout the non-Western world" (15).

[13] To them Toffler refers in the following terms: "Multinational corporate executives, bankers, and money people are not sinister characters out of some *Pravda* cartoon. They are not all spies and counter-revolutionary saboteurs as the T&T role in Chile suggests. They are simply investors, managers, and planners taking advantage of the world's biggest loophole [the lack of adequate regulations for global corporations]--and upsetting the world economy in the process" (1975:78).